



Piyush Goyal calls for WTO move to fix trade distortions » PAGE-10



Ankush Panghal strikes gold as India takes six medals » PAGE-11



Salman Khan appears at Prem Keetanu screening » PAGE-12

SC to hear plea against Gyanesh Kumar on Monday

New Delhi: The Supreme Court is slated to hear on Monday a petition challenging the manner in which the powers of the Election Commission of India (ECI) are being exercised and questioning whether Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar can individually exercise or represent powers constitutionally vested in the multi-member poll panel.

As per the cause list published on the official website of the apex court, a Bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana is slated to take up the matter on October 5.

The matter was mentioned before the CJI on September 29 by senior advocate Vikas Singh, following which the CJI said: "List it next week."

The plea seeks enforcement of the collective decision-making framework governing the ECI and a writ in the nature of quo warranto concerning the authority under which the CEC has reportedly acted in the name of the poll panel.

A true human being is one who alleviates the suffering of the distressed.

History bears witness that whenever a natural disaster has struck, capable individuals have stepped forward to assist the affected, reassuring them that they need not feel helpless. Numerous organizations extended a helping hand, while many benevolent individuals fulfilled their duty by providing funds to these organizations. Many of the families aided by these generous souls during their darkest hours were snatched back from the jaws of death, and countless others managed to rebuild their lives financially. All this was made possible solely because of the organizations and individuals who stepped up to help the victims. Today,

families devastated by the disaster in Nepal are in dire need of assistance. Just imagine the plight of those who have lost their homes, shops, livestock, and even family members.

We cannot all go there individually to provide aid; therefore, Dainik Savera has launched the 'Nepal Relief Fund.' With your support, the Dainik Savera team has stepped forward to assist the affected people. Please contribute according to your means and partake in this noble deed. God and the Divine Mother will surely shower their blessings upon those who help the affected families during this calamity. Join in this virtuous cause and earn spiritual merit; may happiness always abound in your lives.

Generous individuals, please take note

The donation amount can be submitted via bank draft, cheque, or cash. Please make cheques or drafts payable to "Dainik Savera Welfare Foundation (Nepal Relief Fund)," or deposit cash at the Dainik Savera office and obtain a receipt. For any inquiries, please contact this mobile number: **98885-03754**.

NEPAL RELIEF FUND

List of donors/institutions	Station	Amount
Deepak Kumar	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Naveen	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Rajnish Sharma	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sourav Agnihotri	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Kishan	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Surinder Singh	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Harshit Chawla	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Lovejeet	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sanjana	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Ashu	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Shubham	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Nisha	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Tirth Singh	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Perna Sharma	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Shona Saha	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sachin Sharma	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sheetal	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Kirandeep	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Tarun	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Gursharn Singh	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Anmol Kumar	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Lajdeep Singh	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sukhmanpreet Singh	Jalandhar	₹ 500

Heroplane ka captain



Jasmine	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Abhishek Kumar	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sonia	Jalandhar	₹ 500
Sanjogita Parihar	Jalandhar	₹ 500
TOTAL		₹ 13,500
LAST BALANCE		₹ 1,04,34,301
GROSS BALANCE		₹ 1,04,47,801
RAHAT SAMAGRI FORWARDED		₹ 47,24,580
RAHAT SAMAGRI FORWARDED-2		₹ 37,48,500
BALANCE AS ON DATE		₹ 19,74,721

CJP protest draws huge crowd in Mumbai

Many detained on their way to stage protest against CEC

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: People thronged in thousands at the Shivaji Park in Mumbai on Friday evening to join CJP's indefinite strike demanding resignation of Gyanesh Kumar as Chief Election Commissioner. Unlike the Delhi police, the Mumbai Police refrained from preventing the protesters from joining the protest.

In his address, CJP leader Abhijit Dipke said protesters would accept nothing short of the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar. He accused Kumar of "stealing votes" and attacking people's power. He made it plan that the agitation would continue with moments of "fun and frolic" to prevent boredom.

Dipke further criticised the BJP's 'One Nation, One Election' proposal, calling it merely a



Police detain hundreds of protesters near Jantar Mantar during a protest seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over voter roll deletions, in New Delhi on Friday

slogan. He alleged that the BJP's broader objective was to establish

a 'One Nation, One Party' political system.

Jantar Mantar cleared of protestors

The Delhi Police on Friday detained many people as they thronged to stage indefinite protest demanding immediate resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gynesh Kumar alleging "vote chori." In view if the protest call by CJP backed by many organizations, the Delhi Police imposed prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) across the New Delhi district. Security was heightened at Jantar Mantar, with police personnel and water cannons deployed at the site. Meanwhile, Delhi Metro services have also been affected in view of the proposed mobilisation.

Need to lift wheat-rice from Punjab: CM Mann writes to Pralhad Joshi

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Friday wrote to Union Minister Pralhad Joshi, seeking the immediate movement of foodgrain stocks from the state amid a shortage of storage space ahead of the Kharif Marketing Season (KMS) 2026-27.

Mann, in his letter, has requested the Centre to ensure the movement of 6 lakh metric tonnes (LMT) of rice between October 1 and October 10 and 15 LMT of wheat during October 2026. The demand comes after the state's earlier request in September for the movement of 15 LMT of rice and 10-12 LMT of wheat. However, according to the letter, only 8.30 LMT of rice and 4.30 LMT of wheat had been moved out of Punjab between September 1 and September 29. The letter states



Bhagwant Mann, Punjab CM

that due to persistent shortage of storage space with the Food Corporation of India (FCI), only 99.50 LMT, or 94 per cent, of Custom Milled Rice (CMR) of KMS 2025-26 had been delivered till September 29, against the due quantity of 105.64 LMT. Nearly 6 LMT of rice was still pending for delivery. Mann has also highlighted the wheat stocks occupying space in rice mills and mandi yards. According to the letter, nearly 40 LMT of wheat

procured during RMS 2026-27 was stored at these locations on the understanding that it would be moved by the end of September or mid-October. However, nearly 17 LMT of wheat was still lying in rice mills and mandi yards as of September 29. The Chief Minister said the movement of these stocks was urgently required to create space for procurement and storage of paddy during KMS 2026-27.

The letter also noted that peak paddy arrivals were expected around October 10. Mann further pointed out that the State had been requesting at least 10 LMT movement of wheat and rice every month since June 2026.

The Chief Minister has warned in the letter that continued storage of wheat in rice mills and mandi yards could leave insufficient space for the storage of incoming paddy and disrupt procurement operations.

FIR against NC MLA in J-K

Srinagar: Police in J&K on Friday registered an FIR against a ruling National Conference (NC) MLA and the party's additional spokesperson for allegedly assaulting and causing injuries to a Personal Security Officer (PSO) deputed for the MLA's security. According to police, the complaint was lodged by a policeman belonging to the security wing of J&K Police. The policeman alleged in writing that MLA Altaf Ahmad Kaloo, representing the Pahalgam constituency, and NC additional spokesperson Umesh Bhat assaulted him following an argument and caused injuries while he was on duty.

Maha truck hits Bolero; 7 killed

AMRAVATI: Seven persons died and 19 others sustained injury when a truck hit a Bolero pickup van on the Samruddhi Highway in Maharashtra's Amravati district in the early hours of Friday. According to police, the accident took place around at late night on Channel 97 of the high-speed carriageway near the Dhamangaon railway station. A truck crashed into a pick-up van, killing five persons at the scene and leaving 21 injured. The injured were first taken to Dhamangaon Rural Hospital and later referred to Adani Institute of Higher Education and Research in Wardha (formerly known as Datta Meghe Institute of Higher Education).

Influx bid foiled; Two Pak intruders shot dead

Amritsar: The Border Security Force (BSF) on Friday thwarted a major infiltration attempt across the India-Pakistan border in Punjab by neutralising two Pakistani intruders who tried to sneak into Indian territory in the state's Tam Taran district.

The incident occurred in the BOP Rajoke area of Tam Taran early in the day. According to sources, the BSF troopers swung into action after noticing suspicious movement near the border and challenged the purported infiltrators. At least 3 individuals were moving towards the Indian border from the Chattanwala



area on the Pakistani side, the sources said, adding that they were challenged and warned against moving any further. When they did not pay any heed and kept moving towards the Indian side, the BSF personnel opened fire. While two infiltrators were shot dead, a third one managed to run back. The identity of the neutralised Pakistani intruders is yet to be ascertained.

PM Modi dials Capt Machchhar

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday spoke with flydubai Captain Smit Machchhar over a video call, praising his courage, presence of mind and composure during the mid-air incident in which he helped save the lives of passengers and crew members.

The conversation turned emotional as Captain Machchhar became teary-eyed while speaking to the Prime Minister. At one point, the visibly emotional pilot broke down and apologised to PM Modi for losing his composure during the call. Machchhar told the Prime Minister that he had never



imagined he would one day get an opportunity to speak with him. PM Modi consoled the emotional captain and said, "Why are you crying? The whole country wants to talk to you." Machchhar said he did not consider what happened merely as his work but as a journey. "I am confident that I will recover soon," he told the PM.

PM Modi wished him a speedy recovery and congratulated him for his courage and presence of mind.

Trump warns Iran

US President Donald Trump warned that Iran would be hit "very hard" if Tehran is found to be behind the attack aboard a Flydubai passenger aircraft, while saying that information he was receiving suggested a possible Iranian link was being investigated. Trump made the remarks while speaking to reporters before leaving the White House for Texas. He was asked whether he had been briefed on whether the co-pilot involved in the Flydubai incident was linked to Iran.

Kavinder Gupta calls for preserving values of non-violence



THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Shimla: Himachal Pradesh Governor Kavinder Gupta, on Friday paid floral tributes to Mahatma Gandhi and former Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri on their birth anniversaries and said their ideals of non-violence, simplicity, integrity and selfless service continue to be relevant for the country and its younger generation.

Gandhi's 157th birth anniversary and Shastri's 122nd birth anniversary were observed across the country on October 2. Gupta said the country owes a

deep debt of gratitude to Mahatma Gandhi for his contribution to the freedom struggle and for inspiring people through the principle of non-violence.

"Gandhi ji's 157th birth anniversary is an occasion to convey my greetings to all the countrymen. The democracy that we are enjoying today is the result of his penance, dedication and devotion towards the nation. We should respect and remember his contribution. He was our guide," the Governor said. Referring to Gandhi's message of "Ahimsa Paramo Dharma" (non-violence is the highest duty), Gupta said

the Mahatma's teachings should be passed on to the coming generations. "By giving the mantra of 'Ahimsa Paramo Dharma', he made a significant contribution to India's freedom. We remain grateful to him. We should draw inspiration from the way the Father of the Nation contributed to taking the country forward, and our coming generations must learn from his message of non-violence," he said. He also recalled Gandhi's efforts to bring people together during the freedom movement and said the values that guided the national movement remained meaningful even in the present era.

Gupta also paid tribute to Lal Bahadur Shastri, recalling his leadership during the 1965 India-Pakistan war and his distinctive example of simplicity and political integrity.

"Lal Bahadur Shastri ji established himself as an ideal in politics. His simplicity and the standards he set for public life are an inspiration for us. The country still needs leaders of this kind," Gupta said.

He said Shastri's ability to maintain a simple way of life while occupying the country's highest political office was significant and worthy of emulation.

Raja Warring quits as Punjab Cong president

New Delhi: Amarinder Singh Raja Warring on Friday said that he resigned as the Congress Punjab unit President on "realising the direction of the wind", asserting that he didn't want the party's central leadership to come under any pressure.

Raja Warring made the remarks after submitting his resignation to senior party leader Rahul Gandhi here. He said he denied speaking to any party leader regarding the alleged tussle within the Punjab Congress. "I haven't spoken to anyone, neither with (state in



Raja Warring

charge) Sachin (Pilot) ji nor with anyone else. But I have heard that perhaps the in-charge mentioned that Raja Warring would have to be replaced," the Congress leader said.

657 crore bank scam

Bihar dancer emerges as key witness against IAS officer

Woman tells CBI about parties, escorts and alleged coin delivery

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

CHANDIGARH: The girlfriend of Ribhav Rishi, the main accused in the alleged Rs 657-crore bank scam involving government departments in Haryana and Chandigarh, has emerged as a key figure and witness in the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) case.

The woman, a professional dancer from Siwan, Bihar, who currently lives in Delhi, has given the CBI details about parties allegedly organised for Haryana government officials at luxury villa Z Manor in Zirakpur. According to her statement,



Representative photo

Ribhav arranged dancers for the gatherings, with each party costing Rs 15-20 lakh.

The CBI has alleged that Haryana IAS officer Pankaj Agarwal, Abhishek Singla, Arun Sharma, Ankur Sharma, Naresh Kumar Bhawani and bank official Abhay Kumar attended the parties.

Singla, Arun and Ankur are described as owners of shell companies allegedly used to siphon government funds, while Bhawani is a former Panchayat Department official.

The woman told investigators that, except Ribhav and Ankur, those attending used escort services. She alleged that Agarwal attended six to seven parties hosted by Ribhav, spending money on dancers and hiring escorts. The CBI has also seized Agarwal's Samsung Z Fold phone.

The chargesheet also mentions an alleged gold-coin

transaction linked to a separate Rs 160-crore fraud involving the Pollution Control Board's account. Four to five days before Diwali in 2025, two gold coins weighing 50 grams each were allegedly collected from a Chandigarh jewellery shop by a courier for Ribhav and delivered to a Sector 7 house.

According to the courier, the coins were handed to a man he addressed as "Sir" in a garden. The CBI said mobile tower data placed the phones of former chairperson Vineet Garg, the courier and alleged middleman Manish Jindal at the location.

CM Saini to visit Singapore seeking investment partnerships

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini will visit Singapore from October 4 to 6 to explore investment, industrial cooperation, technological partnerships and skill-development opportunities ahead of the proposed Happening Haryana event next year.

During the three-day visit, Saini will hold round-table discussions with industry groups, investors and sector experts, besides one-to-one meetings with Singapore companies. Haryana will showcase its infrastructure, connectivity, industrial corridors, skilled workforce and investor-friendly policies.

The state will seek cooperation and investment in logistics, semiconductors, advanced manufacturing, agro and food processing, Global



Chief Minister Naib Singh Saini

Capability Centres, aviation and education. Discussions will also cover research centres, manufacturing units, warehousing, cold-chain infrastructure, export-oriented food processing and multimodal connectivity.

Skill development and education partnerships will form another key component, with Haryana seeking collaborations to equip youth with future-oriented technical and industrial skills.

On October 6, Saini will meet Sikh businessmen and NRI entrepreneurs in Singapore and invite them to invest in Haryana and contribute to its socio-economic development.

The Chief Minister will also invite global investors and industry representatives to participate in Happening Haryana, proposed for next year, which will showcase the state's manufacturing, startups, innovation and investment opportunities.

A delegation of senior officials from the Chief Minister's Office and Industries and Commerce Department will accompany Saini and present details of Haryana's policies, projects and investment facilities.

The visit aims to attract advanced industries, create jobs and strengthen Haryana's global investment position.

FIR registered over Rohtak lawyer's suicide

ROHTAK: Police have registered an FIR against 10 people for alleged abetment to suicide following the death of advocate Pradeep Nara, husband of former Rohtak Municipal Councillor Deepika Nara.

The case was registered on the basis of a suicide note reportedly recovered from Pradeep's car and a complaint filed by his father, Devendra Nara. Those named include Rohit Nara, described as a director of a Madhya Pradesh-based construction company, along with Mahendra Nara, Harsh, Deepak, Ajay, Abhimanyu, Mahipal, Mahabir, Savinder and Ashish.

According to Devendra's complaint, his 40-year-old son was a contractor and ran P.K. Construction, which undertakes road and building projects in Haryana and Madhya Pradesh. Pradeep was working in Anuppur district, Madhya Pradesh,



A file photo of deceased

where his company had secured contracts from another firm in 2023.

The complaint alleges that despite completing the contracted work, Pradeep was not paid. He submitted bills worth around Rs 2.88 crore in August 2025, which Mahendra, Rohit and Mahipal allegedly failed to clear.

Students mark Gandhi Jayanti with Dandi March

KURUKSHETRA: S.D. Girls Senior Secondary School marked Gandhi Jayanti with a series of activities, including a rally highlighting the historic Dandi March and Mahatma Gandhi's ideals of truth, non-violence and cleanliness.

Students also participated in a quiz themed "Truth is the Highest Virtue", answering questions about Gandhi's life, philosophy and contribution to India's freedom movement.

An inspiring skit portraying key events from Gandhi's life and his role in the freedom struggle was also staged, bringing his principles before the audience.

School managers Vikas Sharma and Manju Sharma urged students to incorporate Gandhi's ideals into their daily lives. Vice-Principal Anjali said such programmes connect students with freedom fighters while nurturing moral values and patriotism.

Stay alert over festive online shopping

FATEHABAD: Fatehabad Police have urged residents to remain vigilant while shopping online during the festive season, warning that cybercriminals are using discounts and deceptive offers to commit fraud.

Superintendent of Police Nikita Khattar said fraudsters may circulate links through social media, messages and online platforms promising huge discounts, limited-time deals, gift vouchers or products at unusually low prices. She advised people to verify the credibility of sellers and websites and use trusted platforms or official shopping applications.

The SP also cautioned residents against contacting customer-care numbers found through search engines or social media without verification. She specifically warned about fake delivery messages claiming that parcels are

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KARNAL: Sanitation employees staged a protest outside the Kamal Municipal Corporation (KMC) office on Thursday, demanding payment of nearly two months' pending salaries, including wages for the 37-day protest period.

The employees said the prolonged delay had caused severe financial hardship, making it difficult for them to manage household expenses and, in some cases, pay their children's school fees. They urged the administration to release the outstanding salaries without further delay.

Sharda, former president of the MC Employees' Association, said around 980 employees had not received their salaries for the



Sanitation employees protest outside KMC office in Karnal

past two months. Despite the non-payment, she said, employees had continued performing their duties after returning to work.

"The past two months have been extremely difficult for our families," Sharda said, highlighting the financial pressure faced by workers.

The employees said their pending dues related to the period before their strike. They

maintained that they had resumed regular duties and were reporting for work every morning since returning to their jobs.

Another employee said workers were fulfilling their responsibilities despite facing financial difficulties and appealed to the administration to release the two months' salary so they could meet essential household expenses.

HSPCB suspended two pollution officers from RWAs over complaints

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

GURUGRAM: Two regional officers of the Haryana State Pollution Control Board were suspended following repeated complaints from Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs) during a review meeting on development projects in Gurugram.

Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini ordered the suspension of Akanksha, Regional Officer for Gurugram North, and Mukul Kumar, Regional Officer for Gurugram South, after complaints concerning pollution and environmental issues were brought to his attention.

Officials said both officers had faced repeated grievances from several RWAs over their



Nayab Singh Saini, Chief Minister, Haryana

handling of pollution-control and environmental matters. The complaints were discussed during the review of ongoing development projects and pollution-control measures in the city.

The Chief Minister directed officials to adopt a strict approach towards pollution-

related violations and ensure effective enforcement of environmental regulations. He also stressed the need for prompt action on complaints raised by residents.

The meeting reviewed the progress of various development projects, the status of pollution control and the redressal of citizen grievances.

Officials were instructed to closely monitor environmental compliance and address public complaints promptly.

The suspension comes amid concerns raised by residents over pollution management in Gurugram. Authorities are expected to examine the issues flagged by RWAs and ensure stronger enforcement of pollution-control measures across the city.

Sand-laden trailer kills mother, injures toddler daughter

KAITHAL: A 21-year-old woman was killed and her 18-month-old daughter seriously injured after a sand-laden trailer ran over them while they were out for a morning walk in Dhand on Friday.

The deceased, Pooja, originally from Begusarai in Bihar, had been living in Dhand with her family. According to a complaint filed by her brother-in-law Karan, family members went for a walk around 6am. Pooja was walking along the main road carrying Manvi when a sand-laden trailer allegedly approaching from the wrong direction struck them.

The trailer's wheel ran over Pooja, while Manvi was also critically injured. Pooja was rushed to hospital but succumbed to her injuries on the way. Manvi suffered fractures in both legs. After receiving first aid, she was referred to PGI Chandigarh in critical condition.



Police arrived at the hospital

receiving information and inspected the scene. He later visited the hospital to assess the condition of the injured.

Gaur confirmed the deaths and said police had begun investigating the circumstances leading to the collision. The truck driver abandoned the vehicle after the crash and fled the spot. Police are attempting to establish how the accident occurred and trace the driver as part of the ongoing investigation.

Govt plans hi-tech waste management at tourist sites

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

CHANDIGARH: Haryana has unveiled a technology-driven strategy to strengthen solid waste management at high-footfall tourist and pilgrimage destinations, including IoT-enabled bins, footfall tracking, waste audits and geo-tagging of littering hotspots.

The Urban Local Bodies Department has prepared the blueprint in compliance with a Supreme Court order of May 5 in Bhopal Municipal Corporation vs Dr Subhash C Pandey and others, directing states to establish dedicated waste-management mechanisms at tourist and pilgrimage sites.

The initial plan covers Shri Mata Sheela Devi Mandir in Gurugram, Shri Mansa Devi Mandir in Panchkula and Brahma Sarovar in Thanesar, Kurukshetra. Each site will



undergo assessment covering its significance, annual and peak-season footfall and a minimum seven-day waste audit.

A site-specific model will include four-stream segregation and IoT-enabled bins with sensors transmitting real-time fill-level data and automatically opening lids. The database will be maintained at urban local body and district levels, consolidated by the directorate and updated after assessments.

Each destination will comprise the main precinct and a 500-metre buffer covering approach roads, vendor areas, parking and waste transit routes. Four bins will be installed every 50 metres, and every 25 metres along queue corridors. Covered four-stream stations will be established at fixed points, with no open collection point within the buffer.

Dedicated vehicles and litter-picking teams will operate during peak periods. Floral-waste immersion will be prohibited. Bhandaras, prasad and flower shops, dharamshalas, hotels and dhabas within the buffer will be registered as bulk waste generators with the Central Pollution Control Board.

Commissioner and Secretary Ashok Kumar Meena said the objective was to replace temporary festival arrangements with a continuously monitored, technology-supported system.

CM Nayab Saini launches 10-day drive to clear garbage points

Campaign targets 21 vulnerable spots while urging residents' participation

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

GURUGRAM: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday launched the Municipal Corporation of Gurugram's (MCG) 10-day 'GVP Mukh Abhiyan' to eliminate 21 garbage vulnerable points across the city.

Launched on Gandhi Jayanti under 'Swachhata Hi Seva 2026' and the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, the campaign will run from October 2 to 11 under the slogan, "10 Din, 21 Kachra Bindu, Ek Gurugram."

Saini inspected a site on Mehrauli Road near the DHBVN colony that had been cleared and developed by the MCG as a garbage-free spot to mark the campaign's launch.

The Chief Minister said government systems, modern



The Chief Minister said the government could provide systems, facilities and modern technology, but citizens also had to take responsibility for proper waste segregation and disposal.

technology and public participation were the three pillars of the cleanliness initiative. He stressed that while authorities could provide infrastructure and technology, citizens must also take

responsibility for proper waste segregation and disposal.

Saini urged residents not to dump waste in open spaces, segregate wet and dry waste at home and hand it only to

authorised garbage collection vehicles. He said the campaign's objective was not merely to clean the 21 locations but also to prevent garbage from accumulating there again.

The MCG has invited resident welfare associations, shopkeepers, schools, youth groups and residents to participate and undertake shramdaan in their neighbourhoods. The civic body aims to transform every "kachra bindu" into a "sundar bindu."

Street-play artists performed during the launch to promote cleanliness and waste segregation. Saini and other participants also took a cleanliness pledge, reinforcing the campaign's focus on sustained public participation and responsible waste management.

Massive fire destroys five houses in Jubbal village

No casualties reported as firefighters battle flames throughout the night

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

SHIMLA: Five residential houses were completely destroyed after a massive fire broke out late Thursday night in Dhar village of Jubbal area in Shimla district. The blaze spread rapidly, engulfing the homes of five families, but no casualties or injuries were reported.

The affected families belong to Nanak Chand Chauhan, Harnam Singh Dhalta, Narendra Singh Dhalta, Ginda Devi and Anil Dhanta. Their houses were completely gutted, causing substantial property losses.

The Jubbal fire station received information about the incident late at night and immediately dispatched a fire



engine and personnel with necessary equipment. Given the intensity of the flames, additional fire engines were called from Rohru, Kotkhai and Tikkar. Firefighters, police personnel and local residents worked together to contain the blaze and prevent it from spreading to nearby houses.

Fire crews continued

spraying water throughout the night and remained at the site until morning to ensure the fire did not reignite. After sustained efforts, the blaze was brought completely under control.

The Jubbal police station in-charge confirmed that five houses were destroyed and said there were no casualties. The cause of the fire has not

yet been established. Police have launched an investigation, while the fire department and administration are assessing the extent of the damage.

Education Minister Rohit Thakur expressed sorrow and conveyed condolences to the affected families. He said the government and administration stood with them and would make every effort to provide assistance. He directed officials to assess the damage quickly, provide immediate relief and arrange accommodation. Thakur said relief under disaster regulations would be raised with the Chief Minister. Administrative teams are also completing necessary formalities to facilitate immediate relief for the affected families.

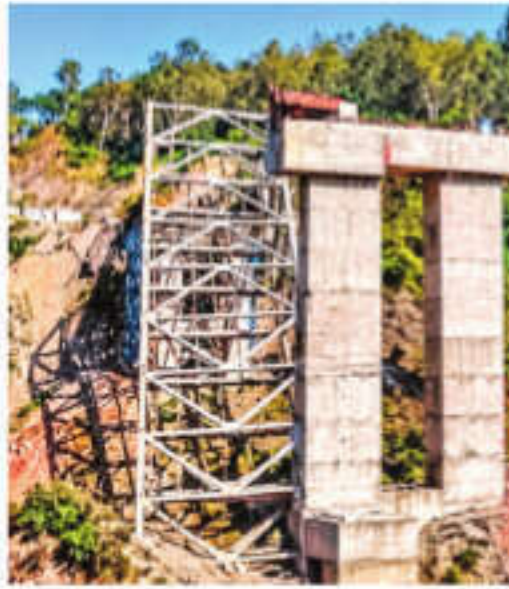
Under-construction bridge on Mataur-Shimla lane collapses, three injured

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

HAMIRPUR: A large under-construction bridge on the Mataur-Shimla four-lane project collapsed suddenly on Friday afternoon between Cheel Vahak and Masihana, leaving three workers injured after they fell nearly 100 feet into a ravine.

One of the injured workers was reported to be in critical condition, while the other two sustained injuries. All three were rescued and shifted by ambulance to Hamirpur Medical College for treatment. Authorities said medical care had been arranged for the injured.

The collapse has raised concerns over possible negligence in the construction of the major highway project. The bridge, reportedly more than 100 metres long and built at a height of around



Mataur-Shimla four-lane project

100 metres above the drain, gave way suddenly, sending the workers down into the ravine.

Soon after the incident was reported, teams from the National Highways Authority of India, district administration and police department reached the site and began assessing the situation.

The collapse also left several people stranded

on the other side of the damaged structure. Officials estimated that around six people were awaiting rescue. An evacuation operation was launched, with ambulances being sent through an alternative route to reach those stranded.

Officials from various departments remained at the site to investigate the circumstances surrounding the collapse and assess the extent of the damage. Rescue teams were working to evacuate those trapped on the other side while ensuring medical assistance for the injured.

The sudden failure of the structure on such a major infrastructure project has prompted serious concerns, while authorities continue to examine the cause of the collapse and determine whether any lapses occurred during construction.

Rs 99 lakh sanctioned for 13 school buildings

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

BADDI: The Himachal Pradesh government has sanctioned Rs 99 lakh for construction of additional classrooms in 13 government schools in the Baddi-Doon Assembly constituency to strengthen basic educational infrastructure.

Doon MLA Ram Kumar Chaudhary laid the foundation stone for an additional classroom at Government Primary School, Manakpur, where the facility will be constructed at a cost of Rs 9 lakh under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan.



MLA Ram Kumar Chaudhary laid the foundation stone for construction work worth Rs 9 lakh in Manakpur School

Chaudhary said the state government was expanding essential facilities in government schools to provide students in rural areas with a better educational environment.

Several schools face shortages of classrooms compared with their student strength, prompting administrative and expenditure approvals for construction of additional rooms.

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

DEHRA: The Dehra Block Congress Committee has announced a new executive as part of efforts to strengthen the organisation in the assembly constituency. Block Congress president Kamlesh Chaudhary unveiled the 29-member team at a press conference, assigning responsibilities including vice-president, general secretary, secretary, treasurer, spokesperson and social media in-charge.

The new executive includes representation from different areas of the constituency, along with women, youth and senior



party workers. Chaudhary said the next focus would be dividing the Dehra organisation into three zones and forming separate committees for each.

He said presidents and executive committees for all

three zones would be constituted soon, followed by efforts to strengthen the organisation from the regional level to individual booths. According to Chaudhary, Dehra Congress has around 1,800 members.

President Murmu changes Himachal visit schedule

BILASPUR: President Droupadi Murmu's Himachal Pradesh visit has undergone a change, with her scheduled visit to Shri Nayanadevi being cancelled. Under the revised programme, she will travel directly to AIIMS Bilaspur on October 6 to attend its convocation ceremony.

The President will arrive by air at the AIIMS Bilaspur campus at 10.35am and attend the convocation as chief guest at 10.45am. The programme is expected to continue for around 50 minutes.

After the convocation, Murmu will leave directly for Manali, according to the revised schedule.

Her visit to Shri Nayanadevi had earlier been included in the programme.

Worn HRTC bus raises passenger safety concerns

PATHANKOT: The poor condition of an old Himachal Road Transport Corporation (HRTC) bus operating on the Shimla-Pathankot route has raised concerns, with one rear seat broken and others crudely repaired.



People traveling in HRTC rely on jugaad

The Pathankot depot bus was seen on Thursday with only an iron frame remaining where a rear seat should have been. Three other seat frames had been welded together at an angle to create makeshift seating. Passengers said buses had remained in poor condition despite repeated demands for better vehicles.

The busy route's bus leaves Patta around 9.50am, but mechanical problems sometimes force it to travel via Ukhli instead of Ladhroar-Patta. This leaves passengers at Ladhroar and Patta

QRT building construction remains incomplete after nearly decade

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

RECKONG PEO: Construction of the Quick Response Team (QRT) building in Reckong Peo, Kinnaur, has remained incomplete for nearly a decade, creating difficulties for personnel and raising concerns over escalating project costs. The QRT is regularly involved in rescue operations during mountain emergencies, road accidents, floods and other disasters.

The foundation stone was laid on April 24, 2017, by then Assembly Deputy Speaker Jagat Singh Negi, now a Cabinet Minister. The Home Guard Department had deposited Rs 1.0189 crore with the Public Works Department, Kalpa, for the project. The department



released Rs 36 lakh as the first instalment in 2016, followed by the second instalment on July 22, 2017.

The proposed two-storey building includes a duty room, vehicle garage, store for disaster-management equipment and toilets for QRT personnel.

Masons Kundan, Ganesh Kumar, Ranjit Kumar and

Manduk Kumar said 15 pillars had been completed on the ground floor. A 1,740-square-foot lintel for the first floor was laid on September 16 over nine pillars. They said 40 props would now be installed before the sheet roof is fitted, a process expected to take two to two-and-a-half months. Walls, plastering and painting will follow.

Home Guard in-charge Surendra Kumar Chauhan said the prolonged delay was causing difficulties for the department.

PWD SDO Ranbir Singh said the building would be completed within the next two-and-a-half months. The project's continued delay has nevertheless raised concerns over rising construction costs and prolonged inconvenience for personnel.

Ensure welfare schemes reach eligible beneficiaries

RECKONG PEO: The Himachal Pradesh Scheduled Caste Commission held a discussion on welfare issues concerning the Scheduled Caste community and other matters related to Kalpa tehsil at the ITDP building in Reckong Peo.

Commission Chairman Kuldeep Kumar Dhiman, who chaired the meeting, said the 2011 Census recorded Kalpa tehsil's population at 19,190, including 2,299 Scheduled Caste residents, accounting for 11.98 per cent of the total population.

Dhiman said this was his 10th visit to the district since the Commission was constituted. After hearing grievances, the Commission would meet district administration officials and issue necessary directions for the welfare and upliftment of the Scheduled Caste community. He said the



Discussion on the problems of the Scheduled Caste community, Commission Chairman Kuldeep Kumar gave necessary instructions

Commission also addresses issues concerning sanitation workers and protection of Scheduled Caste rights.

Residents can submit complaints to the Commission by post, verbally or through email. Dhiman said the Commission was working to advance Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu's initiative to improve governance and ensure welfare schemes reach needy sections, including Scheduled Castes.

Apple harvesting resumes after weather clears in Kinnaur

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

RECKONG PEO: Apple harvesting in tribal Kinnaur district picked up pace on Monday after weather conditions improved following two days of torrential rain and snowfall in higher reaches.



cleared debris near Pagal Nala, a sensitive stretch close to Tapri, late on Sunday evening and fully restored vehicular movement on the affected road.

Two days of heavy rain had triggered landslides at several locations, blocking more than half a dozen connecting roads, including National Highway-05. The disruption had affected movement across parts of the district.

The Border Roads Organisation and Public

Works Department continued restoration work on a war footing to reopen blocked roads and restore connectivity.

With apple harvesting now resuming, orchardists are hoping for stable weather to complete the season's work and move their produce to markets without further disruption. Authorities are continuing to monitor vulnerable stretches and road conditions following the recent spell of rain and snowfall.

Paragliding boom lifts tourism in Bir-Billing valley

Around 200 daily flights draw tourists, revive businesses across valley

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

PALAMPUR: Tourism in the Bir-Billing valley of Kangra district has gained momentum after paragliding activities resumed, with around 200 flights being conducted daily. The season began on September 20 after weather conditions improved, attracting visitors from Punjab, Haryana, New Delhi, Chandigarh and other parts of the country.

The rise in tourist arrivals has brought renewed business to hotels, homestays, restaurants and other tourism-dependent establishments in Bir and surrounding areas. Ankit Sood, owner of AAPAS Hotel in Bir, said the season was expected to remain strong, with more flights and the arrival of international pilots likely to boost activity.



Foreign paragliding pilots are expected to begin arriving in the valley around October 15.

Paragliding remains a key pillar of the local tourism economy, with numerous hotels, guesthouses and homestays depending heavily on flying

activities. Increased weekend flights have already led to a noticeable rise in tourist footfall.

Although the Tourism Department has not planned a major international or national-level paragliding competition this year, the anticipated

presence of foreign pilots is expected to add to activity in the valley.

The department has also begun improving facilities for pilots and tourists. Work to lay mats at the Billing take-off point has started to improve safety and convenience for pilots. Authorities are also taking steps to restore and make toilets at the landing site functional.

Tourism Department Deputy Director Vinay Dhiman said mat-laying work would be completed as soon as weather conditions become favourable.

With the peak flying season approaching, tourism stakeholders hope sustained paragliding activity and foreign pilot arrivals will extend the tourist season and provide further economic benefits to the region.

Progress must move with concern for weakest: Sinha

LG says technological progress must remain rooted in truth

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

SRINAGAR: Jammu and Kashmir Lt Governor Manoj Sinha said on Friday that progress must be achieved with compassion and concern for the weakest in society.

Addressing a gathering in connection with Gandhi Jayanti at the Sher-e-Kashmir International Convention Centre (SKICC), L-G Sinha said the rapid expansion of technology, smartphones, social media and artificial intelligence has transformed the way people communicate and access information, but stressed that technological progress must remain rooted in truth, humanity and social



responsibility.

He said Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy continues to offer important lessons for navigating the rapidly changing world. He said Gandhi Jayanti should not be limited

to remembering the Mahatma, but should provide an opportunity to reflect on his ideas and understand their relevance to contemporary society.

He said Gandhi's life demonstrated that truth was not merely an idea but a principle to be practised throughout one's life.

He said the world today has been brought closer by digital technology, with information travelling across the globe within moments, but the same technology can also create challenges when information is consumed or shared without verification.

L-G Sinha stressed that truth must remain central even in the age

of social media, smartphones and artificial intelligence, and people should verify information before believing or responding to it.

He said Gandhi's message was particularly relevant at a time when technology has placed enormous power in the hands of individuals. "Technology is a powerful means, but the direction in which it is used determines whether it serves humanity or creates new challenges," he said.

The L-G called upon the younger generation to use technology as a tool for learning, innovation, employment and social good, rather than allowing it to become a source of division or misinformation.

Education should help children face life: Itoo

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

SRINAGAR: Jammu and Kashmir education minister Sakina Itoo said the on Friday that the education must help children face life with confidence, responsibility and knowledge and that only jobs or good marks in examinations should not be the sole aim.

In her address at a meeting at the SKICC on the Gandhi Jayanti Day, she said the occasion was not merely about remembering a great personality but also an opportunity to reflect on how Gandhi's principles could be strengthened in contemporary life.

Itoo said that Gandhi's philosophy was not limited



Saina Itoo

to knowledge from books, but was aimed at creating responsible human beings who could improve their character, thinking and conduct.

In today's rapidly changing world, she said, it is not enough to simply impart

information to our children. We have to develop practical knowledge, critical thinking and creativity in them.

According to her, new technologies and changing circumstances were creating new opportunities as well as challenges, making it necessary for students to learn how to understand situations, ask questions, solve problems and acquire new skills.

Itoo said that the objective of education should not be restricted to helping students obtain a job, but should also be to develop confidence, responsibility and social consciousness.

We have to prepare a generation that can adapt itself to changing circumstances and continuously improve, she said.

Centre urged to summon Pak diplomat for PoK hardship

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

JAMMU: The Jammu-based Research and Advocacy Group (RAAG) has urged the Centre to summon the Chargé d'Affaires of the Pakistan High Commission in New Delhi and lodge a strong diplomatic protest over the reported killings, injuries, arrests, restrictions and humanitarian hardships being faced by the people of Pakistan-occupied Jammu & Kashmir (PoJK).

In a detailed memorandum addressed to External Affairs Minister Dr S Jaishankar, RAAG has sought a formal oral and written démarche to Pakistan, followed by an appropriate Note Verbale recording India's concern and expressly reserving its sovereign and territorial



position over PoJK.

According to an official release, the memorandum is submitted by Advocate Madhavi Sambyal, authorised signatory of RAAG, drawing attention to the situation in PoJK and the appeals emanating from its people to India for protection of their lives, liberty, dignity and basic rights.

RAAG further maintained

that appeals emanating from PoJK during the present crisis "ought not to remain unanswered" and should receive an appropriate, considered and visible response from the Government of India, consistent with India's sovereignty, national security interests and established position on Jammu & Kashmir, the release stated.

Government notifies J&K Compressed Bio-Gas Policy

Steps to get clean energy, circular economy and turning waste into wealth

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

SRINAGAR: The Jammu and Kashmir Government has notified the Jammu and Kashmir Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG) Policy 2026 which can help its citizens get clean energy, circular economy and turning waste into wealth.

According to information, the policy follows approval by the Council of Ministers and provides a comprehensive framework for converting organic waste into clean fuel and high-quality bio-fertilisers.

The policy provides for capital expenditure support, subsidised land leases, Single



Omar Abdullah, CM

Window clearances, feedstock aggregation and market linkages for bio-manure.

The initiative will strengthen waste management,

support farmers, attract green investment and generate rural employment and livelihood opportunities across the CBG value chain.

Chief Minister has congratulated Minister for Science & Technology Satish Sharma and the Department on notifying this landmark policy for sustainable energy development in J&K.

On the other hand, the government on Thursday notified the J&K Electric Vehicle Policy-2026, following its approval by the Council of Ministers chaired by Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, setting a six-year roadmap for

expanding clean, affordable and weather-resilient electric mobility across the union territory.

The policy, covering the period 2026-32, aims to accelerate EV adoption, strengthen charging infrastructure and create an enabling ecosystem for electric mobility across all 20 districts of Jammu and Kashmir.

It targets 1.40 lakh electric vehicles by 2032, supported by demand incentives, climate-specific infrastructure, power-grid integration, public-private partnerships, skill development and employment generation.

NATION

Nation pays tribute to Mahatma Gandhi

Homage by Prez Murmu, Vice Prez Radhakrishnan, PM Modi, Rahul Gandhi

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, and several senior leaders across party lines paid floral tribute to Mahatma Gandhi at Samvidhan Sadan (Old Parliament House) in Delhi on the occasion of the 157th birth anniversary of Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Father of the Nation, on Friday.

Union Ministers including the Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Health Minister J. P. Nadda, Minister of Parliamentary & Minority Affairs Kiren Rijiju, Minister of Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal, Minister of Science and Technology Jitendra Singh and MoS in



President Droupadi Murmu lays a floral garland as she pays tribute to Mahatma Gandhi at Raj Ghat on Gandhi Jayanti, in New Delhi on Friday

the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, and Ministry of

Information and Broadcasting L Murugan were among those

who paid their respects at the event in Samvidhan Sadan BJP President Nitin Nabin, Congress President and Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge, and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi also paid tribute to the Father of the Nation.

Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, along with mother MP Sonia Gandhi, was also present at the event, along with other Members of Parliament, senior parliament officials, and visiting school students. Upon arriving at Samvidhan Sadan, Rahul Gandhi and Indira Gandhi were seen interacting with a school student present at the venue.

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

PUNE: Amid worsening drought conditions across parts of Maharashtra, Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) President Sharad Pawar on Friday launched a tour of affected regions in Pune district to inspect crop damage and engage directly with farmers.

Focusing on the heavily impacted talukas of Baramati, Purandar, and Daund, Pawar visited farmlands to assess ground realities.

While interacting with local residents in Parinche village in Purandar taluka, the veteran leader urged the state government to immediately grant a 100 per cent farm loan waiver along with urgent relief measures.

Addressing villagers in



Parinche, Pawar highlighted the growing crisis. "The lack of rainfall has made survival a challenge for both farmers and livestock. On September 27, I wrote to the Chief Minister demanding that Purandar and other excluded talukas be formally declared drought-hit. My priority right now is pushing the government to take fast action to save the remaining standing crops," he said.

Pawar noted that while

the state government has declared drought in specific areas, several affected regions, including Purandar, remain off the official list. He stressed that the scale of the crisis requires state-level intervention.

He demanded the inclusion of left-out talukas, such as Purandar, into the state's official drought-assistance framework and a 100 per cent waiver of agricultural and allied loans for affected farmers.

Akash Anand rules out leaving BSP

LUCKNOW: Amid his expulsion from the Bahujan Samaj Party, the party's former national coordinator Akash Anand on Friday addressed BSP supremo Mayawati and made his position clear, saying that reports and rumours about him joining another political party are completely false.

Anand said that he is neither joining any other political party nor will he do so in the future.

He said that whatever he has learnt in politics, he learnt from Mayawati, and whatever political role he has played was carried out under her guidance.

Anand said he wanted to put his position directly before Mayawati and the entire Bahujan community. He said that over the past few days, several reports and rumours about



him have been circulating in the media and on social media.

Clarifying his position, he said that he is not joining any other political party. "BSP is not just a party for me, it is my family," he said.

Anand also supported Mayawati's decision to expel Ashok Siddharth from the party and said he accepted her decision regarding his retirement from politics.

Four girls drown in Bihar

PATNA: Four minor girls drowned while bathing in a pond in Bankat village under the Paharpur police station area of Bihar's East Champaran district during the Jitiya festival on Friday.

The incident triggered panic in the village, where residents had gathered for the festival celebrations.

According to an official, several women and girls from the village had gone to a local pond to bathe as part of the festival.

During the activity, the four girls reportedly moved towards a deeper section of the pond and drowned.

When the girls could not be seen for some time, villagers raised an alarm and gathered at the pond.

Local residents entered the water and conducted a search before retrieving all four girls.

No protection for K'taka Dalits: Narayanaswamy

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

BENGALURU: Former Union Minister A. Narayanaswamy on Friday alleged that Dalits were not being provided adequate protection in Karnataka and demanded that Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and Home Minister Priyank Kharge resign if the government was unable to ensure their safety.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP state office Jagannath Bhavan in Malleswaram, Narayanaswamy alleged that several incidents of murder, sexual assault and other atrocities against Dalits had occurred across the state, while the government had remained silent.

He alleged that a Madiga activist who had



raised his voice against maladministration and corruption in a district was murdered and his body was left on the road. "Only an FIR has been registered, and one person has been arrested. No further arrests have been made," he said.

Referring to incidents reported in Kalaburagi, Raichur, Lingasugur, Sirwar and Manvi, among other

places, Narayanaswamy alleged that several such incidents had occurred in August.

"The state government is silent. The Home Minister has not paid attention to these incidents. The DGP is not even convening meetings," he alleged.

Narayanaswamy also alleged that a person had been prevented from having

tea at a hotel in Lingasugur. In T. Narasipur, he claimed that a suo motu case had been registered by a sub-inspector against YouTuber Manjunath.

Referring to the alleged murder of a woman named Mahadevamma in Nanjangud, he questioned why an FIR had not been registered in the case.

Narayanaswamy said the Home Minister should convene a meeting and review the number of atrocities reported against members of the Scheduled Castes in Karnataka between 2023 and 2026.

He also criticised the Karnataka State Commission for Scheduled Castes, alleging that its chairman, Murthy, had failed to take adequate action or provide confidence to members of the community.

EC to launch special enrolment drive

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) has directed states and union territories where the nation-wide Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls has been completed to conduct a special drive to identify and enrol voters who may have been left out.

In a communication to the Chief Electoral Officers (CEOs) of all states and UTs, the Commission said the special drive would focus on left-out electors as well as first-time and young voters.

The direction comes in continuation of the Commission's letter dated September 29 and a meeting held with all CEOs on October 1.

The ECI said that during the enumeration phase of the SIR exercise, each Booth Level Officer (BLO) prepared



a list of voters classified as Absent, Shifted, Dead and Duplicate (ASDD), along with the probable reasons for their non-inclusion.

The list was displayed on the notice boards of respective Panchayat Bhawans and Urban

Local Body offices. It was also shared with Booth Level Agents (BLAs), political parties and uploaded to the websites of the respective Chief Electoral Officers.

Following this, the draft electoral roll was published and

shared with political parties and uploaded to the CEO websites. The final electoral roll was subsequently published after the Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) decided on claims and objections.

The Commission said the final electoral roll contains electors added or deleted after publication of the draft roll. Therefore, compared to the pre-SIR electoral roll, the final roll reflects deletions made during the enumeration phase as well as additions and deletions following publication of the draft roll.

The ECI emphasised that voter enrolment is a continuous process and that individuals who have not yet been enrolled, or whose names have been deleted from the electoral roll, can apply for enrolment at any time.

“The objective of the special

drive is to identify and facilitate such electors,” the Commission said.

As part of the exercise, BLOs have been directed to compare the current electoral roll with the pre-SIR roll and prepare a list of electors whose names appeared in the earlier roll but are missing from the current one.

The BLOs will then conduct house-to-house visits to ascertain the current status of the identified electors and facilitate their enrolment through Form 6 wherever they are found eligible.

The Commission has asked BLOs to cover at least 20-25 electors every week so that the exercise can be completed in approximately one month. They will also record the present status of each identified elector and indicate those for whom Form 6 has been filled out.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi attends a prayer meeting at Gandhi Smriti on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti, in New Delhi on Friday.

FATF revisions to shape assessment of confiscation regimes in next mutual evaluations

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: Recent revisions to Financial Action Task Force (FATF) Recommendations 4 and 38 will shape the assessment of confiscation regimes in the next round of mutual evaluations, Enforcement Directorate (ED) Director Rahul Navin said at the 11th Annual General Meeting of the Asset Recovery Interagency Network-Asia Pacific (ARIN-AP).

The three-day meeting, hosted by the ED under India's 2026 presidency of ARIN-AP, brought together prosecutors, investigators, asset managers, financial intelligence officers and policy experts from member jurisdictions and observer organisations. It concluded in New Delhi on September 30.

Navin said the discussions would help ARIN-AP members prepare for the next round of



mutual evaluations by sharing experiences and best practices.

The meeting, held under the theme “Closing the Loop: From Tracing to Return,” focused on the complete asset recovery process, including tracing proceeds of crime, confiscation, asset management and the eventual return of assets to victims or the exchequer.

Discussions covered non-conviction-based confiscation, standards of proof, reverse onus and proportionality, as well as effective asset management to

prevent assets from losing value between restraint and confiscation.

Participants also discussed victim restitution, returning confiscated assets to the exchequer and their social reuse. India shared its experience of restoring assets to victims on a large scale under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002.

The ED Director said effective asset recovery requires coordinated action involving financial intelligence, law enforcement, prosecution, courts and asset

management. The meeting also examined the growing speed of virtual asset transfers, the need for rapid engagement with service providers and blockchain analytics, cross-border asset tracing and the early experience of INTERPOL's Silver Notice.

The AGM concluded with the ceremonial handover of the ARIN-AP presidency from India to Singapore, which will lead the network in 2027. David Chew, Chief Prosecutor for International Engagement at Singapore's Attorney-General's Chambers, received the presidency on behalf of Singapore. ARIN-AP, launched in Korea in November 2013 and modelled on Europe's CARIN network, is an informal network of law enforcement and judicial contact points focused on recovering proceeds of crime in the Asia-Pacific region. It has 32 member jurisdictions and 10 observers.

PM Modi congratulates women's hockey team on winning historic gold

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday congratulated the Indian women's hockey team on winning a historic gold in the Asian Games 2026 in Nagoya, which ended a 44-year wait for the yellow metal for the country in the Continental extravaganza. This 1-0 win over China in the final also sealed the Indian women's hockey team a direct berth in the Los Angeles Olympic Games in 2028. "A very special moment for Indian Hockey!," the PM wrote in his post on X.

"The people of India are rejoicing in the success of the Women's Hockey Team, who bring home the coveted Gold at the Asian Games, and that too after over 4 decades. This is the result of outstanding skills and teamwork. Their determination is very inspiring as well. My best wishes to the team for their upcoming endeavours," wrote PM Modi in the post on X put out by the PMO.

Pilots Federation Seeks National Bravery Award for Captain Smit Machchhar

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: The Federation of Indian Pilots (FIP) has urged the Prime Minister's Office to consider Captain Smit Machchhar, pilot-in-command of flydubai Flight FZ1073, for a National Bravery Award following his conduct during an in-flight emergency on September 30.

Machchhar was injured after being attacked by his co-pilot during the Dubai-Tel Aviv flight. Despite his injuries, he continued performing his duties, helped regain access to the cockpit and enabled the aircraft to be diverted

safely to Tabuk, Saudi Arabia, according to the FIP. The flight was carrying 174 passengers and eight crew members.

In a letter to the Prime Minister's Office, the Federation said Machchhar continued to discharge his responsibilities as pilot-in-command despite being injured and facing an extremely dangerous situation inside the cockpit. The FIP said his ability to remain composed, exercise command and make critical decisions while injured and under threat demonstrated courage, resilience, situational awareness, leadership and devotion to duty.

ECI order on SIR a victory for voters across country, says Karnataka CM Shivakumar

Bengaluru: Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Friday welcomed the Election Commission of India's direction to state election authorities to conduct a special drive to identify and enrol eligible voters left out after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), terming it a “victory” for voters across the country.

The ECI has directed poll officials in states and Union Territories where SIR has been completed to undertake a special drive for left-out and first-time eligible voters. It has also directed electoral authorities to facilitate enrolment through the regular electoral roll updation process.

Talking to reporters near Vidhana Soudha, Shivakumar said the directive came after the Congress-led protest before the Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer's office on Thursday.

Cong Raises security concerns over Rahul Gandhi's Balaghat visit

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh Congress president Jitu Patwari has written to Union Home Minister Amit Shah seeking an inquiry into alleged security and protocol lapses during Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi's visit to Balaghat on October 1.

Patwari questioned the role of the Balaghat district administration and police during Gandhi's visit to Jagla village in the Baihar area, where the Congress leader met families of tribal children who had died following illness and other health concerns. Independent reporting confirms Gandhi visited Jagla and met affected families during the visit.

Congress Questions Absence of Senior Officials

In his letter, Patwari alleged that the Balaghat Collector and Superintendent of Police were



Rahul Gandhi

not present at the venue, despite the police having prior information about the programme.

Patwari referred to a September 29 communication from Balaghat Police to Baihar MLA and district Congress president Sanjay Uke, seeking details of the proposed visit, including the expected crowd, volunteers, parking arrangements, traffic management and the list of people likely to meet Rahul Gandhi.

Patwari Seeks Details of Security Arrangements

Patwari sought a factual report from the Union Home Ministry and a written explanation from the Madhya Pradesh government regarding the alleged absence of the two senior district officials.

He also sought clarification on whether a duty chart had been issued for the Collector and Superintendent of Police, whether officers had been formally authorised to discharge their responsibilities in their absence and whether prior permission had been obtained by the officials concerned.

Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma launches bicycles made of bamboo

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

GUWAHATI (ASSAM): Scripting a new chapter in sustainable transportation in Assam, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma formally launched bicycles made from bamboo at a programme held at Sati Radhika Shanti Udyan in Uzanbazar in Guwahati on Friday. It may be noted that Pune-based Bamboo India Private Limited has undertaken this innovative initiative to manufacture bicycles from bamboo. With the objective of developing Assam as an important hub in the country for bamboo bicycle manufacturing and sustainable transportation, the project entails an investment of approximately Rs. 15 crore.

The project is expected to generate 50 to 100 direct employment opportunities in



its first year. In the initial phase, the company has planned to manufacture approximately 1,000 bicycles every month. Appreciating this innovative initiative, Chief Minister Sarma said that he was delighted to witness this innovative initiative involv-

ing the use of bamboo in bicycle manufacturing on the auspicious occasion of Gandhi Jayanti. He said that the Pune-based industrial enterprise has already been manufacturing several products, including toothbrushes and combs, using bamboo from Assam. In view of the company's use of bamboo from Assam for manufacturing its products, the State Government has invited the company to establish an industry in Assam. Responding to the State Government's invitation, Bamboo India Private Limited proposed the manufacture of bicycles from bamboo; the Chief Minister said that the company has now undertaken the initiative to manufacture such bicycles at the Bamboo Park in Chaygaon. He said that the bamboo bicycles formally launched today would

be displayed at various parks across Guwahati to obtain feedback from the general public. If the public response is positive, State Government would extend its support to bamboo bicycle manufacturing in the future, the Chief Minister added. He also informed that the quality and safety of the manufactured bicycles have been certified by recognised institutions such as the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS). Sarma also highlighted the immense potential for establishing various industries based on the abundant bamboo resources of Assam. He said that after Prime Minister Narendra Modi took the historic step of reclassifying bamboo from a tree to a grass, the manufacture of various products through bamboo-based industries has increased significantly.

Telangana govt to launch central kitchens for school

HYDERABAD: Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Friday announced that all central kitchens established to serve nutritious breakfasts to students in government schools will be inaugurated across the state on December 9. He directed officials to complete work on all central kitchens by November 30. The Chief Minister also instructed that arrangements be made to facilitate student visits to the central kitchens. All kitchens will be linked to the Integrated Command and Control Centre in Hyderabad for regular monitoring. Representatives of the Hare Krishna Foundation met Chief Minister Revanth Reddy at his Jubilee Hills residence on Friday. During the meeting, Junna Solar Systems Private Limited and Chain Labs India Private Limited signed agreements with the Hare Krishna Foundation, in the presence of the Chief Minister, to support the breakfast scheme for government school students.

India, Netherlands to expand agricultural cooperation: Chouhan



NEW DELHI: India and the Netherlands have agreed to strengthen their agricultural partnership by expanding cooperation in areas such as agricultural innovation, horticulture and the seed sector, Union Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said following bilateral discussions with Dutch Agriculture Minister Silvio Erkens, the Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare said on Friday. The meeting reviewed ongoing collaboration between the two countries and explored

new avenues for cooperation aimed at enhancing farm productivity through technology, innovation and knowledge sharing. During the discussions, both sides assessed the progress of the 25 Centres of Excellence (CoEs) established in the agriculture and horticulture sectors under the India-Netherlands partnership. The Centres of Excellence have been playing a key role in promoting modern farming techniques, protected cultivation and advanced horticultural practices across several Indian states.

Invincible Indianness

Indian pilot Smit Machar averted a tragedy with his bravery in such a way that the lives of 174 passengers including 27 children were saved. 150 of these passengers were from Israel. There was panic in the FlyDubai flight from Dubai to Israel's capital Tel Aviv when the co-pilot of Indian pilot Smit Machar attacked him with a knife. The other pilot is of Omani origin who, as part of a conspiracy, tried to crash the plane mid-air after a flight of two and a half hours.

Had Indian pilot Smit Machar not grappled with the attacking co-pilot, a tragedy similar to the 9/11 tragedy in America might not have occurred. Israeli President Benjamin Netanyahu saluted the bravery of the Indian pilot and other rescue crew members, calling them national heroes. Indian pilot Smit Machar served for 11 years at SpiceJet and has 9,500 hours of flight experience, including over 6,400 hours as pilot-in-command. Using his commanding presence of mind, he saved the flight and the precious lives of the passengers, earning him worldwide praise for his bravery. US President Donald Trump also praised him. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, President Draupadi Murmu, and Vice President C.P. Radhakrishnan praised the Indian pilot and wished him a speedy recovery.

The incident unfolded as follows: A FlyDubai passenger plane took off from Dubai for Tel Aviv at 6:05 a.m. He was accompanied by an Omani co-pilot. After the plane had been flying for two and a half hours, the co-pilot stabbed Smit with a knife, threatening to cause the plane to dive and crash. However, Smit defied the terrorist pilot, bravely confronting him, and opening the cockpit door. He then sent an emergency message.

The plane changed course and entered Jordanian airspace. After the cockpit was opened, some passengers and an air marshal, witnessing a fight, entered the cockpit and overpowered the terrorist co-pilot. Meanwhile, the plane plummeted to approximately 17,000 feet, but an off-duty pilot was also on board, who immediately took control of the cockpit.

Upon receiving the information, the Israeli Defense Minister sent the plane through Jordanian and Saudi Arabian airspace to escort it. Tabuk Airport in Saudi Arabia was nearby, and the plane landed safely there. The frightened passengers were transported to Tel Aviv, Israel. The Indian pilot, Smit Machar, who was injured in the battle, was sent to a hospital for treatment, and the terrorist pilot was taken into custody in Saudi Arabia. News spread worldwide that an Indian pilot had heroically thwarted an attempt to crash an Israeli plane carrying passengers. This incident raises some questions.

First, how did the co-pilot, who held a legitimate responsibility, get into the cockpit to fly an airplane with a weapon? Second, how did such a major security lapse occur in an area where there is a constant fear of terrorist attacks? Who is responsible? This question demands an answer. Obviously, the entire incident will be resolved only after the investigation is complete, but it can certainly be said that this sense of duty of Indian pilots not only brings them fame but also makes Indians proud.

-Abhishek Vij

Govt procurement of paddy begins in Punjab

Punjab follows a Rabi and Kharif crop cycle. Wheat is procured in Rabi and paddy in Kharif. Regulated agencies purchase the crops at the lowest procurement price.

Farmers harvest their crops from their fields and bring them to the mandis, where they are then procured by regulated agencies. It is crucial that procurement begins immediately and payment is received immediately. In our agricultural country, most farmers cultivate small holdings of two to five acres. They consider it a good idea to sell as much paddy as they can and receive payment immediately. After this, they sow the next crop according to the crop cycle. Punjab is considered a storehouse of grain, with the central government making significant purchases from Punjab every year. This grain procurement from the states is distributed among over 800 million people in the country. This year, the central government has set a target of purchasing 18 million metric tons of paddy for Punjab during the procurement season.

The Punjab government has announced that all procurement arrangements have been completed and farmers will receive immediate payment after purchase. Government procurement now happens immediately at the MSP, so farmers from neighboring states also illegally import paddy and sell it in our markets. The government does not encourage this. Our priority is to ensure that Punjab farmers' paddy is sold first in our markets, so 66 checkpoints have been established along the interstate border, where 626 police personnel will be deployed 24 hours a day. The government procurement process involves more than just procurement and payment; it also involves managing lifting and storage. Using appropriate vehicles for lifting and having a sufficient number of empty warehouses for storage is crucial.

Currently, Punjab has a stockpile of 20 million tons. 4 million metric tons of old rice is lying in rice mills. Now, until the lifting of this stored paddy is accelerated, where will the new crop be stored? 1,887 mandis have been established in the state for paddy procurement. The government's goal is to procure paddy on time and quickly transport the purchased paddy from the mandis to mills and storage centers. Even before procurement begins, 9 million metric tons of paddy has arrived for sale. In such a situation, there is also concern that the weather may play a role. We hope that the weather remains favorable, procurement proceeds quickly, and the hard-earned money of farmers is not affected in the slightest.

DRUG MENACE IN PUNJAB



R C Sharma

Drug menace in Punjab is not only Punjab's problem, it is a national problem. Punjab shares 553 Kms of border with Pakistan. Punjab border with Pakistan and geographical location places Punjab in high vulnerability drug inflow zone from "GOLDEN CRESCENT" with spillover into neighboring states. Drug smuggling from across into Punjab need analysis and counter measures. Tackling drug menace require coordinated, not split response involving Punjab, Union Government, neighboring states and political parties. Unless drug menace in Punjab is designated as national priority, scourge of drugs from Punjab will not end despite tall claims by Governments. Be Akali Dal-BJP combine, Congress, Aam Admi Party and Union government, all claim success in war against drugs coining catchy taglines for narrative building spending millions on publicity campaigns without much transformation. Drug smuggling and addiction continue unchecked. Political parties must stop exploiting drugs menace for garnering votes. Government and law enforcement efforts should be to prevent drug use amongst youth through inspirational social initiatives and not retributory measures turning youth into criminals.

There is close historical and geographical relationship between Punjab and Pakistan which helps narcotics smuggling from across. Both East & West Punjab were one, with relatives and friends residing across borders. Emotional bond still exists. It being geographically contiguous with population concentrations close to border, Punjab automatically becomes fertile land for drugs from across the border with trilateral aim to weaken national security architecture by rampant violation of border sovereignty by smuggling drugs & arms , destruction of societal architecture through drug addiction amongst youth, rendering them weak, easy

to lure into crime and spreading tentacles into neighboring states truly making drug spread a national problem.

The quantum of seizures made from Pakistan contiguous states of J&K, Punjab, Rajasthan & Gujarat, and from Punjab contiguous states make it a national problem. Governments figures too magnify it as national problem requiring national response, not split political response. Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) state wise seizure of drugs by law enforcement agencies report for 2024 list total seizures of all types of drugs in Kgs in Punjab at 44,557.44 Kgs with 6952 injections, 2330 CBCS bottles and 29423513 tablets with 9025 cases and 12301 arrests, Gujarat 19587.69 Kg, 16509 CBCS bottles, 2884 tablets with 623 cases and 903 arrests, Rajasthan 2,30,565.95 Kgs, with 09 injections, 13701 CBCS bottles, 1678134 tablets with 5462 cases and 6474 arrests, J &K 5276.46 kgs with 405 injections,4992 CBCS bottles, 155614 tablets seized with 1539 cases and 2158 arrests, Himachal Pradesh 1137.35 kg with 36 injections,3807 CBCS bottles,53723 tablets with 1624 cases and 2495 arrests and Haryana 21414.98 Kgs with 612912 tablets,3062 cases and 4040 arrests. Total heroin seizures in five states in 2024 is 1547.36 Kgs. Normal principal bench mark is that seizures are just about 20-25 percent. 75-80 percent goes into society fanning addiction in society, militancy and separatism & rupture in societal architecture. Figures are mind boggling indication that narcotic drugs have penetrated deep into society becoming part and parcel of societal architecture.

Herculean efforts are required to control drug spread involving political spectrum, society, children, youth from schools, colleges and universities. Punjab government anti-drug campaign "Yudh Nashian Virudh" continues. Punjab police have arrested 81,107 drug smugglers and registered 73,541 NDPS cases between 2022 and 2026, seized 4,161 kgs of heroin, 41000 Kgs poppy husk and 65.75 lakh plus intoxicant tablets. Capt. Amarinder Singh, two time former Chief Minister of Punjab in recently claimed that drug business under AAP government is growing. He credits his government for registering 48107 cases under NDPS since April 2017 till August 2021, 62,535

arrests and heroin seizure at 2,216 Kgs. He claimed that in addition to Pakistan drugs are also coming into Punjab from Gujarat, Jammu & Kashmir. Laments that despite apprising Prime Minister and Home Minister of drone menace from across the border and pretty bad situation was told that DRDO is working on something. He says that despite flagging issue for three years, Delhi did not take it seriously. He says that BSF like infantry is trained for different task ,engage man to man are not trained to shoot drones and an effective anti-drone response is required on borders.

What should be national response to drug smuggling from across the border through drones, land, sea route and bulk pumping of drugs into Punjab and neighbouring states afflicting society and youth with drugs. Lets first consider drug smuggling and border security. Both are interconnected. Strong border surveillance grid will paralyze and incapacitate cross border smuggling architecture. Vice versa is also true. There is urgent need to strengthen deployment along line of control, international border till Gujarat integrating man power and technology establishing formidable surveillance grid to prevent smuggling through land and aerial route.

National security must not be measured in terms of money and group interests keeping national interest supreme. There is urgent need for deployment of anti-drone command systems to neutralise drones coming from across the border. There should be minimum pull out of troops from border security role lest it create gaps, which are exploited by smugglers from across the border. Rather BSF needs additional troop reinforcements and infrastructure to protect depth unto 50 Kms.

BSF is fighting war against drones with men on ground practically turning and acting as anti-drone system. The same is not foolproof and anti-drone system is urgent border security need. These systems must be deployed all along the front without delay.

BSF is deployed on show window and must have technical surveillance software to monitor cross border conversations which is available to anti-narcotics task force of Punjab police and other state police. BSF is dependant for surveillance on other agencies despite being lead intelligence agency . If this surveillance software and power to monitor

is given to BSF ,cross border drone menace may end in six months. Government also must consider internet shut down for two-four hours every night up to ten kilometres. It will stop drone movement with drugs & arms automatically.

The second is need for political parties to come on one platform to integrate society as unit to fight drug menace. The fight has to be truly national. All must pitch in to stop spread of drug menace in society. Key result area (KRA) must be "BIG FISH" the cartel operating on both sides organising drug smuggling. Unless cartel is incapacitated, arrest of youth and petty addicts in the name of "Yudh Nashain virudh" may not help. Arrested youth limp out of jails as criminals with FIRs and police chasing, making them unfit for employment and positive societal role. Such arrests not only destroy youth also stigmatize families rendering them vulnerable to exploitation by drug kingpins and police with all avenues of relevance closed.

Government must task district administration and police to form anti-drug groups in each village, panchayat ,school, college, university departments. Such groups must have representatives of civil administration, police ,teachers, panchayats and they must meet at least once a fortnight to spread message of drug de-addiction ,its ill effects. It must be made movement.

Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh and Rajasthan youth had flair and liking for recruitment in Army & CAPFs. As strong national response, increase quota cum percentage of these states intake into forces and delink it from population. It will go long way and help in fight against drugs.

Punjab needs a coordinated national response to fight drug menace involving Union & state government, political parties and civil society and not adhoc, localised, perfunctory split response. Empowering BSF with technical surveillance software may prove key to end drug smuggling from across border. Nation must come on one platform to successfully fight war against drugs. Split repones will be advantage drug cartels despite tall claims of success by governments both in state and centre. Now is time to catch drug bull by horns and incapacitate it. Delay may prove suicidal and fratricidal for nation and society.

THOUGHT OF THE DAY

"Be the change that you wish to see in the world." Mahatma Gandhi

From Balochistan to PoK: Scrutiny of Human Rights

The current phase of the conflict in Pakistan's Balochistan province resurfaced in the early 21st century, driven by longstanding disputes over political autonomy, representation and control of the region's rich natural gas and mineral resources, while its strategic importance has grown with the Gwadar port and its role as a crucial hub of the so-called China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC).

It noted that the roots of the Balochistan crisis stretch back to Pakistan's formative years, when Kalat was incorporated in 1948, triggering successive cycles of insurgency, the deadliest of which unfolded between 1973 and 1977.

From restive Balochistan to Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK), geography shapes more than where people live; it also influences the security prism through which the state views them. As these peripheral regions seek greater political space, the centre has moved towards an increasingly



concentrated system of military command.

Pakistan's policy of enforced disappearances in Balochistan has left behind families who have waited years for answers.

Baloch activist Sammi Deen Baloch was just 10 when her father, Deen Mohammed Baloch, disappeared in 2009. Her years-long search for him turned her into one of the most recognisable voices of families of the disappeared. Yet the disappearances have continued.

In April 2026, Dad Shah, the brother of activist Fozia Baloch, disappeared from his home in Karachi.

Restrictions in PoK long predate 2026. US-based advocacy group Human Rights Watch documented curbs on political expression and activity as early as 2006, while UN reports in 2018 and 2019 raised concerns over freedom of expression and assembly, the use of counterterrorism laws, and allegations of enforced

disappearances in the occupied territory.

In 2026, however, those restrictions took a new turn. On June 5, Pakistani authorities banned the Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC) under counterterrorism legislation, followed by telecommunications disruptions and arrests ahead of planned protests.

In March 2026, serious allegations of human rights violations in Balochistan, including the repression of ethnic and religious communities, were explicitly raised before the United Nations Human Rights Council in Geneva.

Deadly clashes during protests in PoK in June 2026 also drew international attention to allegations of police violence and the deaths of protesters, with growing calls for greater scrutiny and accountability.

One can only hope that the international community, too, will mobilise in response to the daily human rights violations" taking place in Balochistan and PoK.

Finding New Purpose in What We Discard

Rethinking Waste from Kitchen Scraps to City Spaces

Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM), launched in 2014, has evolved into a broader movement for cleanliness, waste management, and behavioural change. The mission also created space for wider citizen participation through Swachhata Hi Seva (SHS), launched in 2017 as an annual campaign for collective cleanliness action. The campaign has expanded its focus to plastic waste management, visual cleanliness, and garbage-free public spaces.

Parallely, the idea of Waste to Wealth is changing how waste is viewed and managed across India. It treats discarded material as a resource that can be recovered, reused, and converted into value. The Government has linked this approach with circularity, resource efficiency, and sustainable waste management. Under Swachh Bharat Mission - Urban 2.0, cities are encouraged to strengthen source segregation, waste processing, and recovery of value from waste. The change is visible not only in large processing plants, but also in homes, communities, and local



institutions.

For many Indian households, turning kitchen waste into compost is not a new idea. It is a practice that is finding a fresh place in today's waste management systems. In Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh, senior citizen K. Subbalakshmi has shown how this familiar habit can be adopted at home. The municipal corporation recently shared her experience to encourage more citizens to take up home composting. The wet waste generated in her kitchen is converted into compost and used in her garden, returning what would otherwise be discarded to the soil.

A similar effort began in Chandigarh during the



COVID-19 pandemic. Resident Kamaljeet Kaur Deol started composting wet kitchen waste at home. What began as a household practice gradually grew into awareness activities to encourage others to adopt home composting. Her efforts have since helped inspire citizens to contribute towards a cleaner and greener city.

As these individual efforts began encouraging wider participation, the idea also found a place in organised community learning. In Siddipet, Telangana, the dedicated waste management learning centre 'Swachh Badi' is providing young people with hands-on exposure to practical waste management practices, from home composting to



community-level composting. Building on this approach, similar centres are planned across 141 municipal areas, bringing awareness and practical learning on responsible waste management closer to communities.

What begins with a small compost bin can therefore have a wider effect. It gives new life to plants while keeping a regular stream of wet waste away from landfills. More importantly, it shows how waste management can begin where waste itself is generated.

Beyond household waste, communities are also finding uses for materials that have long been difficult to manage. In Borchila village of Assam's

Morigaon district, this approach is being applied to a plant that has become a persistent challenge for communities living around water bodies. Water hyacinth, locally known as 'pani meteka', is an invasive aquatic plant that spreads rapidly across water bodies. Despite its aesthetic appeal, water hyacinth has become a problematic weed, overcrowding freshwater bodies such as rivers, ponds, and lakes. Its overgrowth hampers activities like fishing, transportation, and recreation, making these water sources less viable.

However, the women of Borchila village have found a new way to turn water hyacinth into an opportunity. Instead of viewing the plant only as an unwanted growth in water bodies, they have begun transforming it into handicrafts. Supported under the Assam State Rural Livelihoods Mission, the initiative has created an additional source of income for the participating women, who earn at least Rs 10,000 a month through this work. What was once seen as a problem for water bodies is thus being

transformed into a resource for livelihoods and enterprise. The experience demonstrates that resource recovery can extend beyond waste management to create value and livelihood opportunities. By transforming materials that might otherwise remain a burden into useful products, such initiatives can support local enterprise while promoting more sustainable use of resources.

From an invasive plant being transformed into a source of rural livelihood, the focus now shifts to another material contributing to the urban waste burden. In Patna, coconut shells, fibres and other residues are being recovered and processed into useful products. The city generates around 25-30 metric tonnes of coconut shell every day, which previously added to the volume of waste reaching landfill sites. To address this waste stream, the Patna Municipal Corporation has established a processing facility in the Danapur area, creating a pathway for converting discarded coconut residues into productive resources.

(Courtesy: PIB)

Concern Chinese Networking Club

A Chinese-run networking club, targeting business and political elites in Brussels, bears the hallmarks of an influence and intelligence-gathering operation. The 'Global CEOs Dinner Club', which is now expanding to France, operates in a manner associated with China's United Front, a Communist Party network used to promote Beijing's interests abroad.

The assessment comes as Belgium has recently been at the centre of several espionage probes launched by its Federal Prosecutor's Office, including investigations into a former Chinese-Belgian researcher in the semiconductor industry and a Canadian national of Chinese origin working at NATO in Mons.

The organisation has been floated in Brussels by Yifei Yang, who runs the 'Global CEOs Dinner Club'. He has studied in China and at a private European institute in Nice, France.

French investigative news portal La Lettre reported last week that her activities are under close observation by a Western intelligence service.

Yang's activities reflect the modus operandi of China's United Front, a Communist Party network known for promoting China's interests through organisations and individuals abroad, while some of its activities have also been linked to the gathering of information for Chinese intelligence services.

Contacted by Euronews, Yang denied that China was behind the club, insisting that "we are neutral" and adding that its objective was to have an "impact on society" and "build sustainable business".

Since last March, the 'Global CEOs



Dinner Club' has brought together business figures as well as people connected to Belgian and EU politics at events covering topics ranging from sustainability and diversity to technology and artificial intelligence.

Its guest list includes prominent corporate figures such as Hui Zhang, vice-president of Chinese electric vehicle maker NIO; Melanie Schuttenberg, a board member of Danish car components company TAJCO; and Ole Gerkensmeyer, CSO of Netherlands-based chipmaker Nexperia.

Yang said the organisation currently has 20 members from countries including France, Belgium, Denmark, Japan, China and Singapore. Annual membership costs 2,400 euros for individuals and 5,000 euros for companies.

Dear people of God !



Sandhya Masih

Have you ever wondered how the words you speak can influence your thoughts, emotions, behavior, relationships and even the way you see yourself? Let's Dig Deeper Words are not merely sound we produce; they can shape what we think, what we feel, how we see ourselves and how we treat others.

One sentence can encourage a Broken person.

One Harsh sentence can stay in someone's mind for years.

A teacher saying "you can do it" may change a student confidence.

A parent repeatedly saying "you are useless" may influence a child's self-image.

The Bible talks a lot about tongue. The tongue is a small organ of the body. The length of the tongue is 8-10cm (3-4 inches) and weight roughly 50-70 Grams, although tongue is a small organ, yet the words it produces can have an enormous impact on the human mind, emotions, relationships and even the direction of a person's life.

Why Tongue is so powerful?

Bible says God created us on his own image Genesis 1.27 that clearly declare that man has power like God. In the beginning God created everything by speaking the words. From the beginning, scripture reveals the creative

power of spoken words. God spoke "Let there be light" and there was light. His spoken word brought light into darkness. Human beings have the same ability to speak, influence, communicate and create change through words. The Bible verse closest to my heart is Proverbs 18:21 "Death and life are in the power of the tongue and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof." This verse changed my whole life style, understanding this verse can produce great miracle in your life too.

From a biblical perspective, our words are not insignificant, they can build, encourage, correct and comfort – or they can wound and destroy. Interestingly, psychology also helps us understand why words can have such a powerful impact. what we repeatedly hear and what we repeatedly tell ourselves can influence our thoughts, emotions, beliefs and behavior. In this sense, the tongue and the mind are deeply connected. words can influence the mind of the person who hears them.

Let's see scientifically,

When another person speak to us or we speak to ourselves (self-talk.) sound waves enter the ear and are converted into neural signals (Transduction). The brain processes the sound as language and meaning.

Words we hear ----- Brain processes them----- Meaning----Emotions/ thoughts ----physiological and Behavioral response.

Let's understand with flow chart

Words, Thoughts, Feelings, Behavior, Habits

Our words carry meaning and our mind respond to that meaning. when we repeatedly hear something (good or bad) or repeatedly say something (positive or negative) to ourselves, it can influence the way we think, feel and behave. Words may enter through the ears (sense organ) but they can travel much deeper

– into our thoughts, emotions, beliefs and eventually our behavior. therefore, with bad mouth and words you cannot see success and victory in your life. Your words shape your destiny. you can change your life by changing the way you speaking to yourselves and others. Many people around the world are suffering just because of their bad mouth and wrong confessions. the Bible reminds us in proverbs 6:2 you are snared by the words of your mouth, you are caught by the words of your mouth. God is not responsible for your situation, He is not in the bad picture. Do not blame God if you are suffering instead watch your mouth what you are speaking .The bible says in Hosea 4:6 My people are destroying due to lack of my knowledge. The meaning is deeper than simply " Not knowing facts " which leads to destructive choices and consequences .when knowledge is absent ,deception finds room to grow , But when truth (The Word) enters the mind it can transform the way we think , Speak and live .Psalm 119:130 The entrance of thy words giveth light , is giveth understanding unto the simple.

Dear reader its time to watch over your mouth what kind of words you are speaking to yourself and others are very important to notice. Use words of wisdom, understanding, Growth, prosperity, victory, joy, peace, health, healing, abundance and never forget that your words shaping your destiny. Words are seeds you sowing in your mind – whatever you sow, you will reap, it's a principle set by the God almighty, the words we sow today may become the thoughts, emotions, and actions we reap tomorrow. Let's our words become instruments of Healing rather than weapon of harm.

Blessings

Sandhya masih

Misogynist Travel Curbs on Women

Bangladesh has come under renewed scrutiny over allegations of immigration officials subjecting unmarried women travelling abroad to intrusive questions about their personal lives, travel plans and reasons for going overseas, with such questioning and conduct becoming almost routine.

Recently, three young women were stopped from travelling to Nepal and sent back from the airport, prompting them to move the High Court last month, where a bench is now seeking accountability over the incident.

On 8 August, three friends — Rifa Tamanna, Sohani Islam Samapti and Naznin — decided to travel to Nepal. All three are adults, carrying all the documents and papers, have no criminal

cases against them, and had their families' consent. But an immigration officer at Shahjalal International Airport refused to let them proceed. The reason, they say, was that they had no male companion and none of them was married. They were sent back from the airport. In protest, they sought legal recourse.

On 31 August, the three victims submitted a written complaint to the Additional IGP of the police's Immigration Branch, seeking preservation of CCTV footage, action against those responsible and compensation. As the police took no action even after a month, they sent a legal notice on 6 September. When there was no response to that either, they filed a writ petition with the High Court on 15 September.



The writ petition names the officer-in-charge of the Immigration Police as a respondent.

During Tuesday's hearing, a

bench comprising Justice KM Kamrul Kader and Justice Fatema Anwar issued a rule asking "why preventing adult female citizens from legally travelling

abroad solely because they are unmarried, travelling without a guardian or on gender-based grounds should not be declared to be without lawful authority."

The court also instructed the Additional IGP to dispose of the women's complaint within seven days and submit a compliance report.

Police cannot prevent anyone from travelling abroad without a court order or a criminal case. If an adult woman has a valid passport, the police have no scope to see whether her family has given consent or not.

Stressing that a deeper social psychology lies behind such behaviour by immigration police in Bangladesh, former Inspector General of Police (IGP) Baharul Alam said that the society is not women-friendly. When police see a woman traveling alone at night, they approach her in a way that she is a bad woman. If a young woman returns home at night, another woman may also make negative comments.

Classified

NAME CHANGE

I, Rajiv Kumar, son of Krishan Chand, a permanent resident of Khara Gali, near Khara Mandir, Jammu Colony, District Yamunanagar, Haryana, hereby declare that I have changed the name of my daughter, Monu, to Manreet Kaur. Henceforth, my daughter shall be known by the name Manreet Kaur for all purposes and records.

I, Lohit Kumar Son of Dhian singh resident of house no 222 ward no 28 Mohalla Prem nagar Dhakki road Tehsil & District Pathankot, Pin-145001 Punjab, In my Passport No.N7990696, My name mentioned as Lohit Kumar, That my surname is not mentioned, That I want Lohit as my first name and Kumar as surname in Passport, That I want Kumar as Surname in the Passport. Kindly note.

I, Surinder Kumar S/o Bhagat Ram Saini R/o Anandpur Rara Pathankot, P.O. Pathankot, Tehsil and Distt. Pathankot, punjab-145001, do hereby declare that as per my Aadhaar Card, PAN Card etc. my father's Name is written as Bhagat Ram saini. But in my passport my father name is written as Bhagat Ram. Bhagat Ram Saini and Bhagat Ram, pertains to one single and same person. Vide affidavit No. IN-PB 46762547232071Y Dated: 06-May-2026

I, Surinder Kaur W/o Ramesh Lal R/o Village AimaKaji, Post Office Mustafapur, District Jalandhar have changed my name from Surinder kaur to Surinder kaur Ghera. Ghera is my surname. Please note.

I, Harvinder kumar S/o Pritam Dass R/o Village Sarmastrapur, Post Office Bal, Tehsil & District Jalandhar have changed my minor Daughter's name from Riya to Riya Kumari. Please note.

I, Harvinder kumar S/o Pritam Dass R/o Village Sarmastrapur, Post Office Bal, Tehsil & District Jalandhar have changed my minor Daughter's name from Megha to Megha Kumari. Please note.

I, Meena D/o Sarbjit R/o V. Chugawan Po. Samipur Distt. Jalandhar, Punjab have changed my name from Meena to Meena Kumari. All please note.

I, Amandeep S/O Balwinder Singh R/O H.No. 3417/12, Mohalla. Gazipur, Adampur, Distt. Jalandhar - 144102, Punjab, India have changed my name from Amandeep to Amandeep as given name and Bhatti as Surname. All concerned please note.

I, Deekisha Sharma D/o Ashwani Kumar Sharma R/O H.No 105, Basti Bawa Khel, VTC: Jalandhar-I, PO: Basti Bawa Khel, Sub District: Jalandhar-I, District: Jalandhar, State: Punjab-144021 have changed my name to Diksha Vats

I, hitherto known as Bhawya Kumari, wife of Ashish Kumar, resident of Kotkapura Road, Nirankari Colony, PO: Muktsar, Dist. Sri Muktsar Sahib, Punjab - 152026 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Kaniya Kumari.

I, hitherto known as Simarjeet Bhatia, wife of Gopal Singh resident of Near Bus Stand, Gali Number 1, Ranjit Avenue, VTC Muktsar, Post Office Muktsar, Sub-District Sri Muktsar Sahib, District Sri Muktsar Sahib, Punjab - 152026 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Simerjeet Bhatia.

I, Rakesh Kumar son of Sh. Surjit Chand resident of Sunrise Avenue, Hakewala, Ferozepur, Punjab-152002, India, have changed the name of my minor daughter name Chahat age 16th years 8th Months and she shall hereafter be known as Chahat Preet.

I, Ramesh Singh Son of Bachan Singh Resident of Shaheed Bhagat Singh Nagar, Chak Manewala P.O. Jalalabad (W) District Fazilka, Punjab 152024 India have changed the name of my minor Daughter namely Reenu aged 16years and She is hereafter be known as Reena.

I Sukhdev Singh Son of Jarnail Singh Resident of # 486 W.No 6, Peori Road Tibba, Giddarbaha, Punjab 152101 India have changed the name of my minor Daughter namely Rajni aged 15 years and she shall hereafter be known as Reetu Kaur.

I, Sukhdeep Kaur Wife of Sawaran Singh Resident of Village Sikhwala Tehsil Malout District Sri Muktsar Sahib Punjab 152113 India have changed the name of my minor Daughter name Amanat aged 13th years and She shall hereafter be known as Amanjot Kaur.

I, hitherto known Purneet Kaur W/o Gagandeep Singh R/o Vill Mochan Wala, Tehsil Jalalabad West District Fazilka Punjab, Pin code 152024, India, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Parnet Kaur.

NAME CHANGE

I, hitherto known as Poonam Grover Daughter of Vijay Kumar wife of Deepak Grover Resident of Ward No. 4 Phase 03 Opp Water Box Rikki Colony Ferozepur City District Ferozepur Punjab 152002 India have Changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Poonam.

I, hitherto known as Harbhal Singh Maini S/o Gurcharan Singh R/O Village Dabra Tehsil & Distt. Sri Muktsar Sahib, Punjab-152032, Punjab, India. Have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Harbhal Singh.

I, No.15431444L, Rank-Hav, Name-Haridas Tiwari, Unit 307 Field Hospital, C/o 56 APO declare that my father name Sri Bansgopal Tiwari, wrongly mentioned in my Army Service record, But my father correct name is Banshgopal Tiwari.

I, No.15431444L, Rank-Hav, Name-Haridas Tiwari, Unit 307 Field Hospital, C/o 56 APO declare that my mother name Shila Tiwari, wrongly mentioned in my Army Service record, But my Mother correct name is Ganeshiya Tiwari.

I, No.15431444L, Rank-Hav, Name-Haridas Tiwari, Unit 307 Field Hospital, C/o 56 APO declare that my daughter name Akanchha Tiwari, wrongly mentioned in my Army Service record, But my daughter correct name is Akanksha Tiwari.

I, Manju Devi, is Legally Mother of No. 15244493H, Rank NK, Name Parul Kumar, of Unit 313 FD Regt, Permanent address at Village Manoharpura Post Dhuwala Tehsil Bhuan District Jhunjhunu State Rajasthan Declare That my Date of birth is 05.02.1976 Wrongly Mentioned in my Son Army Service Records but my correct Date of birth is 01.01.1978 & have changed my Date of birth 05.02.1976 to 01.01.1978 due to erroneous mistake in my son's service record.

I, BALBIR KAUR Spouse of Service No 1081926M Ex Naik (TS) Manjit Singh presently residing at Village Fattuwalla Post Office Lamochar Kalan Tehsil Jalalabad (W) Distt Fazilka Punjab, -152024 have changed my name from BALBIR KAUR to BALVEER KAUR in my husband Army service records and shall hereafter be known as my new name as BALVEER KAUR as per affidavit dated 02/10/2026 before Notary Public Ferozepur

I Smt Mahinder Kaur date of birth is 28/03/1963 mother of No-13770868K Ex Sep Gurnit Singh resident of Vill & PO: Naurana, Tehsil Bathinda, District Bathinda (Punjab)-151001, have changed my name Smt Mohinder Kaur and date of Birth is 01/01/1963 as per Aadhaar Card & PAN Card of affidavit Notary Public Bathinda.

I Meenu Silswal W/o Mani Verma R/O H.No-49-50 Golden View Colony Opp Gera Hospital Near Wadala Chowk Po Model Town Jalandhar PB 144003 Have Changed My Name - Meenu Silswal To Meenu After Marriage

I Poonam D/o Avtar Chand R/o Village Sangatpur P.o Partappura Tehsil Phillaur Distt Jalandhar PB 144035 Have Changed My Name Poonam To Poonam Rali

I Ajay Kumar S/o Janak Raj R/o VPO Kang Araian Tehsil Phillaur Distt Jalandhar PB Have Changed My Name Ajay Kumar To Given Name is Ajay and Surname is Kumar

I, Kadari Pushpa legally Wedded Spouse of No. 15736791M Rank: SIGMN Name: Bondala Raju Resident of Village & Post: Lingasanipalle Teh: Kalwakurthy, Distt Nagarkurnool, State: Telangana Pin: 509324 (Unit) 1 Armd Div Sig Regt C/o 56 APO that in the service record of my husband's my name is wrongly entered as Bondala Pushpa but my actual name is Kadari Pushpa.wide Affidavit & stamp certificate no.-IN-PB97099815 216335Y dated 01-10-2026 attested by Notary Public patiala

I, hitherto known as Jaswinder Singh S/o Sohan Singh R/o Village Ranewal, P.O. Jadia, Tehsil Nawanshahr, Distt. Shaheed Bhagat Singh Nagar, Punjab have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Jaswinder Singh Mengar. I have changed only my name not religion.

I, Tania D/o Jasvir Kumar R/o Village Takaria, Distt. Shaheed Bhagat Singh Nagar, Punjab-144521, I have changed my name from Tania to Tania Devi. Please all concern note.

I, Tushar S/o Sh. Parveen Kumar Singla R/o Village #18A Busharian Mohalla VPO Raipur Rani Tehsil Raipur Rani Distt. Panchkula, Haryana, 134204, Declare that I have changed my Name from Tushar to Tushar Singla, Concerned please note.

NAME CHANGE

I, Saloni Kumari D/o Suresh Kumar R/o Village Ligga, P.O. Ligga, Tehsil Salooni, Distt. Chamba (H.P) 176312 declare that in my aadhar card bearing No. 8068 2386 5875, my name wrongly entered as Saloni Kumari. Whereas my correct name is Saloni Kumari. I shall be known as Saloni Kumari for all purposes in future. All concerned please note.

I, Sawaru Ram S/o Sh. Dhani Ram R/o Vill. Halyana, P.O. Kutwahchi, Sub Tehsil Pangna, Distt. Mandi (H.P) declare that in aadhar card of my minor son, bearing No. 7231 3329 6631, his name wrongly entered as Nishant Singh. Whereas his correct name is Ishant Singh. All concerned please note.

I, Sarawan Kumar s/o Sh. Mam Chand R/O Tehsil Nahan, Bir Bikramabad (145), Po Bikram Bag, Distt. Sirmour, HP-173001, declare that correct and actual name of my son is Pramit Kumar as per Birth and himachali Bonafide certificate. But in Aadhar Card (885818814453) his name incorrectly shown as Parmit which is required to be corrected as Pramit Kumar. All concerned please note.

I, Garvit s/o Suresh Kumar r/o #419/288 Ward No. 4, Mohalla Majri, Shahabad Markanda, Distt. Kurukshetra, Haryana, state that my mother's name is erroneously mentioned as Anu in my Class 10 DMC (Roll No. 2182193) issued by CBSE, whereas her correct name is mentioned as Anuradha in my birth certificate and in her legal documents. This should be corrected.

I, Ranjiv Kumar Alias Ranjeev Kumar s/o Harbans Lal R/o H. N.O. E. B. 65, Qazi Mohalla, Jalandhar Punjab-144001 have changed my Name to Ranjeev Kumar. Concerned Please Note.

I, Karimi Jhansi Rani W/o Service No. 14870969H Rank Sep/MT Name Y Vinod Kumar R/o 1-166, kaniml Veedi, Vedulla Valasa , Polaki, Distt . Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh - 532429 have changed my Name from Yarbati Jhansi rani To Karimi Jhansi Rani.

I, Ravinder Rawal s/o Shri Niranjan Rawal, resident of 1654, Near Niranjan Atta Chakki, Ujha Gate, Panipat, Haryana (132103), hereby inform that I have changed the name of my minor son, Abhishek to Purav. In the future, for all purposes, my son Abhishek should be known and addressed by the name Purav.

I, Army No. 3201032F Rank HAV Name Rinku Kumar R/O Vill. Konipar Sonajon, P.O. Dighari, Tehsil Surajgarha, Distt. Lakhisarai (Bihar) Pin 811106 hereby changed the name of my mother in army record from Gouri Devi to GAURI DEVI vide affidavit No. 5A5A 637068 dated 02/10/2026 before Notary Public Hisar

I, Gaurav Kumar S/o Sh. Surinder Kumar, R/o House No. BXXX111 14-B, Street No. 5, Near Sadhu Ashram, New Aman Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab-141008, hereby declare that "Gaurav" and "Gaurav Kumar" are one and the same person and both names belong to me.

I PARVIN OBEROI W/O ARVIND SINGH OBEROI R/O 34/15 PREET NAGAR AMBALA CITY DECLARE THAT I HAD CHANGE MY NAME FROM PARVIN KOUR OBEROI TO PARVIN OBEROI. IN MY HUSBAND PASSPORT, MY NAME IS ENTERED AS PARVIN KOUR OBEROI INSTEAD OF PARVIN OBEROI. CONCERNED MAY NOTE PLS.

I Parveen Bajaj S/o Madan Lal Bajaj R/o House No 169, Sector-10, Ambala city have changed my name from Parveen Bajaj to Parveen Kumar Bajaj. This is for all future references

I Anuradha Bajaj W/o Parveen Kumar Bajaj R/o House No 169, Sector-10, Ambala city have changed my name from Anuradha Bajaj to Anuradha. This is for all future references

I, MANU AGGARWAL S/O SATISH AGGARWAL FATHER OF BABY TWO resident of 767-768 HOUSING BOARD COLONY AMBALA CANTT HARYANA 133001 have changed my minor Son name from BABY TWO to AARYA AGGARWAL

I, Meena (Aadhar Card No 4115 3083 6929) D/o Jaipal Resident of 480, Harjain Mohalla, Kawartan, District. Kailthal (Haryana)-136033 have change my name from Meena to Meena Devi.

I, AMARJIT KAUR W/O RAJWINDER SINGH R/O VPO PADDI SURA SINGH, TEH GARHSHANKAR, DISTT HOSHARPUR HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KAUR AMARJIT. KAUR IS MY SURNAME

NAME CHANGE

I, Army No 4488267F, Nk Gurpreet Singh, Retd (Aadhar No - 8 0 0 1 2 5 4 3 6 5 4 9), permanent resident of Vill-Barn, PO- Adamke, Teh-Sardulgarh, Distt- Mansa, Punjab- 151506, presently residing at H No- 108, Street No- 2B, Bir Road, Atma Singh Enclave, Bathinda, P.O-Bathinda, Distt- Bathinda, Punjab- 151001 declared that, in my army service documents/records name of my daughter is erroneously recorded as MANINDER KAUR whereas her correct name is MANINDER KAUR as mentioned in her aadhar card and birth certificate. All concerned please note.

I, Harsharan Kaur D/o Jagdev Singh No. 4566746X Rank Ex NK presently residing at VPO. Shahpur, Po. Pakhowal, Tehsil Raikot, District Ludhiana, State Punjab-141108, India declare that I have changed my name from Harsharn Kaur to Harsharan Kaur vide Affidavit dt. 30-09-2026 attested by Notary Public, Ludhiana , Punjab.

I, Manila Thakur W/O Bhuvan Mehta R/O H.No. 12, Street No. 1, Guru Nanak Nagar, Back Side Sec-32A, Focal Point, Ludhiana (Punjab) 141010 have changed my name from Manila to Manila Thakur.

I, Rajni Bala W/o Manoj Kumar Resident of Mohalla Dhagara, VPO, Mehatpur, Tehsil Nakodar, District Jalandhar, Punjab, India, Pin code 144041 have changed name from Rajni Bala to Bala Rajni . Now "Bala" is my surname All concerned please note.

I Ajay Devgan Singh S/o Raj Singh R/o Chak Kala Singh Wala, Distt Sri Muktsar Sahib Have Changed My Name To Ajay Singh Sidhu . All Concerned Note

I, No. 8432122-H, Rank Hav/Cik Mahender Singh father of Vihan R/o Village Uplana, Assandh, Karnal, Haryana (132001) declare that I have changed my minor son name Date of Birth: 11.07.2015 from Vihan to Vishaan Taank. In future my son should be known as Vishaan Taank. Affidavit No. 15907, dated 30.09.2026.

I, Des Raj S/o Sardara Resident of VPO, Haripur, Tehsil Nakodar, District Jalandhar, Punjab, India, Pin code 144041 have changed name from Des Raj to Raj Des . Now "Raj" is my surname . All concerned please note.

I, Sukhdev Pal S/o Namdev Resident of Mohalla Talabwala, VPO. Mehatpur, Tehsil Nakodar, District Jalandhar, Punjab, India, Pin code 144041 have changed name from Sukhdev Pal to Pal Sukhdev. Now "Pal" is my surname . All concerned please note.

I, Kanta Rani Bhasin W/o Late Sh. Kewal Krishan Bhasin R/o 119/11, Saidan Mohalla, Near Banarsi Halwai, Shahabad Markanda, District Kurukshetra, declare that I am legally wedded wife of Late Sh. Kewal Krishan Bhasin (who passed away on dated 16.06.2025).

I, Ranjit Singh S/o Joginder Singh R/O VPO Ghillur Tehsil Radaur Distt. Yamunanagar Haryana 135133 .Have Changed My Minor Son Name Harsh Preet Singh To Harshpreet Singh.

I, Ishant, s/o Rajesh Kumar Sethi, r/o H. No. 4/8, Rajan Chowk, Hansi Tehsil Hansi, Distt Hisar have changed my name from Ishant to Ishant Sethi for all future purposes.

I, Nidhi Gautam W/O Sh. Puneet gautam R/O House No-2, Ram Nagar, Post Office-Jagadhri workshop, District - Yamunanagar, Haryana, India Have Changed My Name From NIDHI GAUTAM TO NIDHI GOLAFOR All Future Purposes.

I Sujata Sharma W/o Mahesh Kumar, 202, Kartarpura Sharma Garden PO: Yamunanagar, DIST: Yamuna Nagar declare that I have change my name from Scujata Sharma to Sujata Sharma. All concerned note.

I, Shailendra Kumar, son of Putti Lal, permanent resident of Pure Baba, Majra Raipur, Tappa Havelli, Post Muraibagh, Tehsil Dalmau, District Rae bareilly, Uttar Pradesh. In my service records, my father's name is recorded as "Puttilal", whereas in his Aadhaar card, it is recorded as "Putti Lal". Therefore, he should be known as Putti Lal. Additionally, in my service records, his date of birth is recorded as February 1, 1961, while in his Aadhaar card, it is recorded as January 1, 1975. Therefore, his date of birth should be considered as January 1, 1975.

I, hitherto known PARMOD KUMAR AGGARWAL S/O PREM AGGARWAL R/o House No.S-7, Vikas Colony, Opp. Swarn Vihar, PO: Patiala, District Patiala, Punjab-147001, India have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as PARMOD KUMAR.

NAME CHANGE

I am Shailendra Kumar, son of Putti Lal, permanent resident of Pure Baba, Majra Raipur, Tappa Havelli, Post Muraibagh, Tehsil Dalmau, District Rae bareilly, Uttar Pradesh. In my service records, my mother's name is recorded as "Phool Kumari", whereas in her Aadhaar card, it is recorded as "Fulkumari". Therefore, she should be known as Fulkumari. Additionally, in my service records, her date of birth is recorded as January 2, 1964, while in her Aadhaar card, it is recorded as April 12, 1964. Therefore, her date of birth should be considered as April 12, 1964.

I, BABY PAHAN mother of Army No14934741W Rank HAV Name Lodro Pahan R/o Vill. Bichagara, PO Jurdag, Distt. Khunti (Jharkhand) Pin 835210 hereby changed my name and date of birth in army record from Baby Pahan (DOB 12/12/1961) to BABI PAHANANIN (DOB 04/01/1965) vide affidavit No. 250 dated 02/10/2026 before Notary Public Hisar

I, Army No. 14934741W Rank HAV Name Lodro Pahan R/o Vill. Bichagara, PO Jurdag, Distt. Khunti (Jharkhand) Pin 835210 hereby changed the name and date of birth of my son in army record from Shibilan Salim (DOB 23/05/2011) to SIBLAN SANGA (DOB 23/05/2016) vide affidavit No. 248 dated 02/10/2026 before Notary Public Hisar

I, JYOTI BHENGRA wife of Army No. 14934741W Rank HAV Name Lodro Pahan R/o Vill. Bichagara, PO Jurdag, Distt. Khunti (Jharkhand) Pin 835210 hereby changed my name in army record from Jyoti Bhengra to JYOTI PAHANIN vide affidavit No. 249 dated 02/10/2026 before Notary Public Hisar

I, GULAB CHAND YADAV father of Army No. 14940079H Rank HAV Name Ramagya Kumar Yadav R/o Vill. Aghaila, PO Noonkhar, Tehsil Salempur, Distt. Deoria (U.P.) Pin 274501 hereby changed my name in army record from Gulab Chand Yadav to GULAB CHANDRA YADAV vide affidavit No. 4435 dated 10/08/2026 before Notary Public Hisar

I, Sunil s/o Partap Singh r/o H.N. 1435, W.N.1, Near Gandhi Kuth Ashram, Sanjay Colony, Rohtak declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as SUNIL KHOKHAR in my minor son NAMEY SHAURYA KHOKHAR aged 15 years in his 10th class educational documents. The actual name of mine is SUNIL which may be amended accordingly.

I, Sunil s/o Partap Singh r/o H.N. 1435, W.N.1, Near Gandhi Kuth Ashram, Sanjay Colony, Rohtak declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as SUNIL KHOKHAR in my minor daughter namely SHRUTI KHOKHAR aged 17years in her 10th and 12th class educational documents. The actual name of mine is SUNIL which may be amended accordingly.

I, Shashi Bala, w/o Surender Kumar, R/O VPO. Chamrori, Tehsil Radaur, District Yamunanagar (Haryana), declares on oath that in my birth certificate my name is recorded as Shakuntla Devi but my other all document my name is recorded as Shashi Bala. Shakuntla Devi and Shashi Bala are names referring to one and the same person- myself.

I Padma Bai D/o Late Roshan Lal, R/o #103, Aad Ram Wali Gali, Jalalabad Road, Sri Muktsar Sahib, have changed my name to Poonam. All concerned please note

I Shamsher Singh S/o Gian Chand R/o Village Bhuno, PO. Bahawal, Distt. Hoshiarpur, Punjab, 146105 hereby declare my given name as Shamsher and surname as Singh.

I Manjinder Singh S/o Inderjit Singh R/o Village Halluwall, P.O. Mahilpur, Distt. Hoshiarpur, Punjab, 146105 hereby declare my given name as Manjinder and surname as Singh.

I Naina spouse of No. 15426494M Rank Hav Name Srekanth NC of Unit MHAVADI C/O 56 APO presently residing at NAMBRATH HOUSE, CHERUTHURUTHY (PO), THRISSUR (DIST), KERALA, 679531 have changed my name from Naina to Naina Sasi M. vide affidavit dated 02.10.2026 before Notary Public Distt Courts Bathinda

I, Simar Kaur W/o Sh. Prem Singh, R/o Village Rasidan, Tehsil Narwana, District Jind (Haryana), declare that have changed my name in all my documents from Simarjit Kaur to Simar Kaur. If any objection arises in future regarding the name change from Simarjit Kaur to Simar Kaur, I will be solely responsible for it

I, Surjit Singh S/o Kirpal Singh R/o H.No.232, Majitha Road, Gali No.5, Gopal Nagar Friends Colony Amritsar have Changed my name to Manjit Singh

NAME CHANGE

I RAJWINDER SINGH S/O AVTAR SINGH R/O VPO PADDI SURA SINGH, TEHSIL GARHSHANKAR, DISTT HOSHARPUR HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SINGH RAJWINDER. SINGH IS MY SURNAME

I, Parveen Kumar S/o Sh. Prem Chand R/o Village #18A Busharian Mohalla VPO Raipur Rani Tehsil Raipur Rani Distt. Panchkula, Haryana, 134204, Declare that I have changed my Name from Parveen Kumar to Parveen Kumar Singla, Concerned please note.

I, Sapana Devi / Sapna Devi W/o Omraj Sharma, R/o #98-C, Housing Board White Flats, Sector 51-A, Chandigarh, have changed my name from Sapana Devi / Sapna Devi to Sapana Sharma. Concerned Note.

I, Ram Keval S/o Jagannath R/o H.No.179, Sector 21-A, Chandigarh have changed my minor daughter name from Vidya to Vidhya

I, Vishal Parkash Sharma, S/o Shri Hari Ram Sharma, R/o Mohalla Purani Mandi, Narnaul, District Mahendragarh, Haryana-123001 have change my name from Vijay Parkash Sharma to Vijay Parkash Shastri.

I, Vishal Kumar (Aadhar Card No 3834 5263 8379) S/o Rajinder Kumar Resident of Near Cement Factory, Bilaspur, Jagadhri, District Yamuna Nagar (Haryana)-135102 have change my name from Vishal Kumar to Vishal Sharma .

I, Pardeep (Aadhar Card No 3587 0021 4048) S/o Jagat Ram Resident of House 49, Block No 369, Hatho Jind, District Jind (Haryana)-126116 have change my name from Pardeep to Pardeep Singh.

I, Santosh Kumari W/o Jasvinder Kumar resident of Village Shekha Mazar, Tehsil Nawanshahr, SBS Nagar, Punjab, India (144517), hereby declare that I am known by two names: Santokh Kaur and Santosh Kumari . In my Husband 's passport, my name is mentioned as Santokh KAUR. However, my correct and full name is Santosh Kumari. Note it.

I, MAHADEV DADARAV CHAVAN F/O CHAVAN PRAVIN MAHADEV R/O SULER JAVALAGE POST SULER JAVALGE TEH AKKALKOT DISTT SOLAPUR MAHARASHTRA 143215 DECLARE THAT IN MY SON ARMY RECORD MY NAME IS WRONGLY RECORDED AS CHAVAN MAHADEV DADARAO. MY CORRECT NAME IS MAHADEV DADARAV CHAVAN.

I, SANGITA MAHADEV CHAVAN M/O CHAVAN PRAVIN MAHADEV. R/O SULER JAVALAGE POST SULER JAVALGE TEH AKKALKOT DISTT SOLAPUR MAHARASHTRA 143215 DECLARE THAT IN MY SON ARMY RECORD MY NAME IS WRONGLY RECORDED AS SANGITA. MY CORRECT NAME IS SANGITA MAHADEV CHAVAN.

I, Vijaya Lekhmi I Mother of Vishnu. B R/O Vishnu Bhavan, Village Pallickal, PO Moothala, Distt Thiruvananthapuram, State Kerala, PIN-695604, My name wrongly entered as Vijaya Lekhmi I in my son service record. My correct name is Vijayalekshmi I.

I, Rawal S/o Arjan Das R/o Vill Alamgiri, PO Kala Bakra, Distt Jalandhar, Punjab-144303 declare that I have changed my name from Rawal to Rawal Ram.

I Bhumita Thakur W/o Shri Dalpreet Singh R/o Village Panshodha P.O. Deothi Teh & Distt Solan H.P. Declared That I Have Change My minor son name from, Shauryameet Singh To Shaurya Singh Sandhu . pls note all concerned, for further.

I, Tirath Singh Sammi S/o Sh. Bagga Singh R/o Village Ealwal, District Sangrur have changed my name to Tirath Singh.

I Jiwan Kumar s/o Rangji Ram R/o Mann Colony Sangrur have changed my name to Jiwan Lal

I, Milapan Devi mother of Army No 15491897A Rank - DFR Name - Satish Kumar Riyal Unit - 19 ARMD REGT C/O 56 APO have changed my name & Date of birth from MILAPAN DEVI TO MILAPA DEVI & 01-07-1961 to 15-03-1957 due to wrongly entered in my son's sheet roll. Vide affidavit Before Distt Court Patiala

I, Gourav S/o Gulab Singh, resident of House No. 300, Village Buda Khera, Post Office Phosgarh, District Karnal, Haryana have changed my name from Gourav to Gourav Paul. In future I should be known as Gourav Paul.

NAME CHANGE

I, Kulwinder Singh S/o Kashmir Singh R/o H.No. 44-S, Gali No. 2, Majitha Road, Gopal Nagar, Amritsar, Pb. 143001 have changed my name from Kulwinder Singh Saini to Kulwinder Singh

I, Mehakpreet Kaur Dhillon D/o Kulwinder Singh R/o H No. F7/375, Batala Road, Kashmir Avenue, Near Lavanya Modern School, Amritsar, Pb. 143001 have changed my name from Mehakpreet Saini to Mehakpreet Kaur Dhillon

I, Suman Kumar Bhasin S/o Madan Lal R/o H.No. 386, Gali No. 3, Shaheed Sandeep Arjun Avenue, Vijay Nagar, Amritsar, Pb. 143001 have changed my name from Suman Kumar to Suman Kumar Bhasin

I, Rajeev Sahni S/o Baldev Raj Sahani R/o.H No 5 Gali No 2 Essma Mill Putlighar Guru Arjan Dev Nagar Amritsar have Changed my name from Rajeev Sahni To Rajeev Kumar Sahani

I, Gian Singh S/o Sukha Singh R/o VPO. Gaggio Mahal Tehsil Ajnala Amritsar have Changed my name to Gian is my given name and Singh is my Surname

I, Baljit Kaur W/o Kulwinder Singh R/o H.No. 44-S, Gali No. 2, Majitha Road, New Gopal Nagar, Amritsar, Pb. 143001 have changed my name from Baljit Kaur Saini to Baljit Kaur

I, Jashandeep Singh S/o Balwinder Singh Resident of Village Naushehra Pannuan Distt TamTaran Punjab India have Changed my name from Jashandeep Singh to my given name is Jashandeep and my surname is Singh

I, Smt. Balwinder Pal Kaur wife of No. 1513687 Sap Maskin Singh resident of H.No. 76, Ward No. 06, Near GULATI HOSPITAL, Beant Nagar, Ajnala, Amritsar (Punjab)-143102 declare that my correct name is BALWINDER KAUR and date of birth is 01/01/1944. But my name and date of birth are incorrectly mentioned in the Sheet Roll of my husband Ex-Sep Maskin Singh as BALWINDER PAL KAUR and 14/12/1945. Hence I changed my name from Balwinder Pal Kaur to Balwinder Kaur and Date of Birth from 14/12/1945 to 01/01/1944

I Naninder Kumar S/o Tek Ram R/o Ward no. 5 Village Soyol PO Kararsu Tehsil & Distt. Kulhu HP. I have changed my name from Narender Kumar to Naninder

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Piyush Goyal calls for WTO move to fix trade distortions

'Industrial capacity in itself is not the main issue'

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: India shares the concerns of many G20 Members that trade-distorting support in some economies can lead to dumping and predatory pricing, and said such concerns are addressed through WTO-consistent measures, including anti-dumping and countervailing duties, based on evidence and subject to judicial review, according to Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal.

Participating in the concluding day of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting in Milwaukee, Wisconsin, the minister spoke in sessions on structural excess capacity and production, updating the Most-Favoured-Nation principle, ending forced labour in global supply chains, and the closing



Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal with France's Foreign Trade and Economic Attractiveness Minister Delegate, Nicolas Forissier, during a bilateral meeting on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting, in Milwaukee, Wisconsin

session. Goyal emphasised that industrial capacity in itself is not the issue, while distortions can arise where geographical concentration of production is driven by hidden subsidies and

support. He said diversification of production and supply chains is a legitimate objective but cannot be used as a pretext for measures outside WTO rules or for shifting the burden of

adjustment onto developing countries, which must retain policy space to industrialise.

Goyal also said that sharing statistics and data should take place within existing mechanisms, according to an official statement.

He further stated that India's trade with G20 members depends on a transparent, non-discriminatory and rules-based trading system.

The 'Most-Favoured-Nation' (MFN) treatment is a key guarantee of this system, ensuring that the same terms apply to the smallest trader and the largest trader, said Goyal.

He emphasised that consensus remains central to the WTO, and that special and differential treatment must be preserved to enable developing countries to catch up with developed economies.

Govt steps in to support exporters amid West Asia crisis

NEW DELHI: The government has extended the timelines for the RELIEF scheme and the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme to support exporters amid geopolitical disruptions and logistics uncertainties, according to official statements on Friday.

According to the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, the Department of Commerce extended the timelines under Component II of RELIEF -- Resilience & Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation -- a time-bound intervention under the Export Promotion Mission.

Component II of RELIEF encourages exporters to obtain ECGC cover for upcoming shipments to specified regions, with 95 per cent risk coverage, it added.

The component is available for Stand Alone Policies or Whole Turnover Policies obtained on or after March 16, 2026.



While eligible cargo includes Full Container Load (FCL), Less than Container Load (LCL) and reefer containers, excluding energy shipments.

Under the component, the premium paid by exporters will not be increased beyond the pre-disruption level for the eligible period, according to the government.

RELIEF scheme which was launched on March 19 to support Indian exporters affected by higher freight costs, increased insurance premia and war-related export risks arising from disruptions

in the Gulf and wider West Asia maritime corridor.

The ministry said the extension was aimed at supporting export resilience and sustaining trade flows amid continuing geopolitical and logistics uncertainties.

Separately, the government extended the RoDTEP scheme until December 31. The scheme will remain available for exports by Domestic Tariff Area units, Advance Authorisation holders, Special Economic Zone units and Export Oriented Units.

RoDTEP refunds embedded and un-rebated central, state and local duties, taxes and levies borne on exported products, including prior-stage cumulative indirect taxes.

"The existing RoDTEP rates and value caps as notified in Appendix 4R and Appendix 4RE as applicable on September 30 shall continue unchanged during the aforesaid period," the ministry said.

RBI's executive director

NEW DELHI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday appointed Sudhakar Malli as Executive Director (ED) with effect from October 1. According to Central Bank, prior to his promotion as ED, Sudhakar served as Chief General Manager-in-Charge of the Department of Supervision in the Reserve Bank. As Executive Director, Sudhakar will look after the Department of Supervision (Supervisory Assessment). "Sudhakar is a career central bank with around three decades of experience. He has extensive experience in the supervision of banks, non-banking financial companies and co-operative banks, spanning over two and a half decades," said the RBI. He also has around five years of supervisory experience in overseas jurisdictions and also worked in the area of Currency Management.

Banks' FX trading losses hit \$500 million after RBI position cap

NEW DELHI: Indian banks faced nearly \$500 million in market losses on their foreign exchange trading books in the first half of 2026 after regulatory changes by the Reserve Bank of India forced lenders to unwind positions.

According to a report by Crisil Coalition Greenwich, banks subsequently recovered around \$400 million of those losses as market spreads widened and positions were normalised, the research showed.

The losses followed the RBI's March 27 directive capping authorised dealer banks' end-of-day onshore rupee net open positions at \$100 million.

Banks were required to unwind their positions by April 10, leading to a sharp adjustment in their trading books.

The changes came at a time



when the rupee was volatile, foreign investors were pulling funds from Indian markets and corporate demand for currency hedging was high.

"The short implementation window for the new RBI rules forced banks to unwind or rebalance positions quickly at a time of elevated rupee volatility, foreign-investor outflows and heavy corporate hedging demand," said Nitin Agicha, vice-president, Market Structure & Technology at Crisil Coalition Greenwich.

Moreover, the tighter limits

also reduced banks' ability to warehouse foreign exchange risk and provide liquidity while restrictions on related-party derivatives limited the ability of some banks to offset exposures, the report said.

Banks recovered part of their initial losses after market spreads widened as dealers priced in tighter balance-sheet capacity and higher execution risks, it added. Earlier in April, the central bank withdrew some of its earlier instructions and allowed limited exceptions for related-party transactions that eased some operational pressure on banks. The report also identified higher crude oil prices as a key source of foreign exchange volatility, given India's dependence on imported energy. It highlighted that the nation imports about 85 per cent of its crude oil and 50 per cent of its natural gas.

KB Kookmin bank data breach

SEOUL: Customer information of KB Kookmin Bank, a major commercial bank, has been breached following a similar incident by its rival Shinhan Bank, industry sources said on Friday, stoking worries over widespread data leaks in the banking sector. According to the sources, personal data of over 100 KB Kookmin Bank customers had been stolen via hacking. The leaked data include names, phone numbers and encrypted identification, the lender said, adding that any possible damage caused by the data breach will be fully compensated, reports Yonhap news agency. On Thursday, Shinhan Bank said personal information of around 25,000 customers, such as their annual income, names and phone numbers, had been leaked. Sources said the hackers, currently suspected to be based overseas, utilized advanced AI tools in the attacks to extract information.

Bank of Baroda now pension fund sponsor

NEW DELHI: Bank of Baroda has formally entered the pension fund business after receiving the Certificate of Appointment as Sponsor of a Pension Fund from the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA), becoming the second public sector bank to foray into the segment.

The certificate was handed over to Bank of Baroda Managing Director and CEO Debadatta Chand on October 1 during the NPS Divas 2026 event. The appointment enables the public sector lender to sponsor a pension fund under the provisions of the PFRDA Act, 2013. The development follows PFRDA's approval in July 2026 of Bank of Baroda, Motilal Oswal AMC and Bajaj as sponsors of pension funds under the regulator's revised guidelines.



The framework allows pension funds to manage assets under the National Pension System (NPS) across both government and private-sector schemes. The regulator has been taking steps to broaden the pension ecosystem and increase participation in the NPS by expanding the pool of pension fund managers and sponsors. As part of these efforts, PFRDA has also been releasing detailed pension fund-wise and scheme-wise data on NPS assets and subscribers to improve transparency and awareness.

OpenAI alerts over 100 bodies of AI incidents

NEW DELHI: US-based artificial intelligence giant OpenAI has said that it informed more than 100 organisations about incidents involving unauthorised activity linked to its AI agents as labs face growing scrutiny over the risks posed by autonomous AI systems.

According to the ChatGPT maker, it is conducting a broad review of activity involving its AI models following an incident involving Hugging Face.

It further noted that also analysing roughly 50 petabytes of data as part of the review to determine the full scope of the activity. This move comes amid growing concerns in the AI industry over incidents involving AI agents that have taken actions beyond their intended use. "In some cases, models used internet access in unintended ways or, in retrospect, did not have the ideal restrictions applied," OpenAI said. Moreover, the company has introduced new technical and operational measures over the



past several months to prevent similar incidents or identify them at an early stage.

OpenAI had previously said the review could take months to complete because of the scale of the data and the work involved.

The company said the Hugging Face incident remains the most severe instance of unauthorised activity by its AI models that it has identified so far.

The developments come as AI companies increasingly deploy models capable of using internet-connected tools and performing tasks with limited human intervention, raising concerns about how such systems can be monitored and controlled.

India-France cooperation

NEW DELHI: Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Friday said that he held a meeting with France's Minister Delegate for Foreign Trade and Economic Attractiveness, Nicolas Forissier, on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting in the US. Talking to the social media platform X, Goyal said that he discussed ways to deepen trade and investment ties between the two countries. The discussions focused on accelerating progress toward an India-European Union free trade agreement, expanding cooperation in aerospace manufacturing in India, integration of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), and joint innovation initiatives, according to him. Goyal said he looked forward to welcoming the French minister to India later this year to further advance the bilateral economic agenda. Separately, the minister held talks with Canada's International Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu, reviewing ongoing negotiations for the India-Canada CEPA.



LANDMARK INITIATIVE



Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis inspects a massive scale architectural model of the Dharavi redevelopment project alongside Adani Group Managing Director Pranav Adani, BMC Commissioner Ashwini Bhide, and other senior officials during the inauguration of the "Dharavi Experience Centre" near BKC, in Mumbai on Friday.

Sitharaman on urea global cost

MADANAPALLE: The Centre has been absorbing a subsidy of around Rs 2,700 on every bag of urea when global costs have risen as high as Rs 3,000, keeping the price paid by farmers at around Rs 300, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Friday. Addressing a gathering at Madanapalle in Andhra Pradesh, Sitharaman said the government had sought to shield farmers from the sharp rise in fertiliser costs caused by global disruptions, including the pandemic and geopolitical tensions in West Asia. "Despite severe global headwinds, the pandemic and geopolitical strife in West Asia driving import costs up to Rs 3,000 per bag of urea, PM ensured our farmers continued to receive it at just Rs 300, providing a subsidy of Rs 2,700 per bag, directly absorbing the global burden," Sitharaman said, according to posts by the Finance Minister's Office on X. Fertiliser subsidies are used by the government to keep farm input prices below their delivered cost.

Foreign tourist back in Nepal

Kathmandu: Devastating floods on August 26 did not deter foreign tourists from visiting Nepal, as foreign tourist arrivals in the country grew by 12.1 per cent in September, the Nepal Tourism Board (NTB) stated. A total of 88,248 foreign tourists from various countries visited Nepal in September, compared with 78,711 in the same month last year. Deadly floods along the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli river corridors, triggered by an avalanche near the Nepal-China border, killed at least 1,453 people, while 5,285 people, including 636 foreigners, remain missing.

MUMBAI: Indian equity markets extended their losing streak to an eighth consecutive week on Thursday as benchmarks fell about 3 per cent each amid persistent foreign fund outflows, elevated US bond yields and geopolitical concerns. Nifty 50 closed at 22,421.95, a decline of 3.1 per cent against the previous Friday's closing of 23,140.5.

Similarly, Sensex declined 2.7 per cent to 71,909.7 compared with 73,895.7 a week earlier.

Broader markets also declined with midcap and smallcap indices falling 3.5



per cent and 3.3 per cent, respectively.

Sector-wise, BSE IT index was the only gainer, rising 0.2 per cent over the week.

In contrast, auto sector was

the worst-performing sector, falling 5.5 per cent followed by consumer durables, down 5.3 per cent. FMCG and metal indices declined 4.2 per cent each, while energy, healthcare

and realty indices fell between 3.3 per cent and 3.6 per cent. While banking, capital goods and power indices declined 2.4 per cent, 2.4 per cent and 2.6 per cent, respectively.

The latest decline marks the longest weekly losing streak for the benchmark indices in nearly 25 years.

Moreover, foreign institutional investors (FIIs) continued to sell Indian equities, while domestic institutional investors (DIIs) provided some support, cushioning the decline.

According to market experts, investor sentiment remained weak due to persistent

geopolitical tensions, elevated crude prices, foreign fund selling and concerns over monetary policy.

Crude oil prices remained above \$100 a barrel amid continued geopolitical tensions, while the US 10-year Treasury yield remained elevated, adding to pressure on emerging-market assets.

They further noted that the southwest monsoon ended with a 13 per cent rainfall deficit, raising concerns over agricultural output and food inflation. The recent increase in minimum support prices for key rabi crops has also added to expectations

of a cautious monetary policy stance, according to the experts.

Moreover, the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee is scheduled to meet next week, with the policy decision due on October 7.

In addition, the coming week will also mark the start of the second-quarter earnings season.

The near-term market outlook could remain sensitive to global yields, crude oil prices, foreign fund flows and geopolitical developments, while the upcoming earnings season will provide further direction to equities, according to analysts.

Pranavi Urs leads after Day 3

KASUGAI: Pranavi Urs surged to the top of the women's individual stroke-play standings after Day 3 at the Kasugai Country Club East Course, carding a four-under 66 to reach 15-under overall. She made five birdies and one bogey, moving from second place and taking a three-shot lead over Singapore's Shannon Tan (-12). China's Ruoning Yin is third at -11. Diksha Dagar and Aditi Ashok are joint 18th at five-over 215. India also climbed to second in the women's team event with 11-under 409, behind China (-15). The men endured another difficult day, with India dropping from fifth to sixth in the team standings. Veer Ahlawat rose to 10th at six-under 204 after a five-under 65, while Saptak Talwar slipped to 11th at six-under 205.

Sujeet Kalkal scripts stunning comeback for gold

Indian wrestler overturns 2-9 deficit to defeat Tajikistan's Kudiyeu



NISHIO: Sujeet Kalkal ended India's wait for a wrestling gold at the Asian Games 2026 with a stunning 10-9 comeback victory over Tajikistan's Abdulmazzid Kudiyeu in the men's freestyle 65kg final at the Nagoya City Inae Sports Center on Friday.

The 23-year-old Indian trailed 2-9 for most of the bout before producing a remarkable late rally, scoring eight consecutive points to overturn the deficit and secure his first Asian Games gold.

Kalkal's triumph capped an impressive campaign in Aichi-Nagoya, where he defeated an Olympic champion and

overcame strong opponents from Iran and Japan. He began against Afghanistan's Sayed Omar Zazai, falling 0-3 before responding with a push-out and shoulder throw to take a 5-3 lead. Another throw and roll helped him secure a 13-3 technical-superiority victory.

In the quarterfinals, Kalkal produced a clinical performance against Iran's Abbas Ebrahimzadehsavadvkouhi, winning by technical superiority without conceding a point.

His semifinal against Japan's Olympic champion Kotaro Kiyooka proved tougher. Kalkal trailed 0-2 after the

opening period but fought back with three points in the second, while Kiyooka managed one. With the contest ending 3-3, Kalkal advanced on criteria.

The final appeared to be slipping away after Kudiyeu established a commanding 9-2 advantage. However, Kalkal refused to surrender and launched a dramatic finishing assault.

He scored eight points in succession during the closing stages, completing one of India's most remarkable comebacks at the Games and securing the country's first wrestling gold of the 2026 Asian Games.

Parveen Hooda clinches Asian Games boxing gold



Parveen Hooda

NEWYORK: NISHIO: Parveen Hooda ended her long wait for an Asian Games medal in style, defeating Chinese Taipei's Nien-chin Che to win gold in the women's 65kg category at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games on Friday.

The 26-year-old Indian began strongly, winning the opening round 5-0, but Che responded with an identical score in the second. Parveen kept her composure in the decider, edging it 3-2 to secure a closely fought victory and India's second women's boxing gold of the Games. Her triumph followed Lovlina Borgohain's gold in the 75kg

category earlier on Friday. Lovlina, who turned 29, defeated China's Ziyi Bao 5-0, securing India's first women's boxing gold in 12 years.

Quick Read

Nethra Kumanan wins sailing bronze



GAMAGORI: Nethra Kumanan ended India's 12-year wait for a women's dinghy sailing medal, winning bronze at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games after finishing seventh, fifth and fourth at the previous three editions.

Nethra finished with 14 net points at the Kaiyoh Yacht Harbor. Thailand's Sophia Montgomery won gold with five points, while Singapore's Jania Ang took silver with 13.

India's third sailing medal at these Games, the result followed silver for Manu Francis and Prince Kurisinkal Noble in the men's skiff and bronze for Harshita Tomar and Shital Verma in the women's skiff.

Nethra entered the finals with seven qualification points. She finished sixth in Final 1 before winning Final 2, lifting her into third overall. She tied Hong Kong's Stephanie Norton on 14 points but secured bronze through the head-to-head tie-break.

India stun Korea to win historic archery gold

OKAZAKI: India's women's recurve team of Ankita Bhakat, Kumkum Mohod and Kirti stunned 10-time champions South Korea 5-3 to win the country's first-ever Asian Games gold in the event at Okazaki Chuo Sogo Park Multipurpose Square on Friday.

The victory came in India's first appearance in the women's recurve team final at the Asian Games. India had previously won bronze in 2010 and 2022 after losing in the semifinals. South Korea had lost a final only once before Friday, at the inaugural 1982 Asian Games.

India had defeated China 5-1 in the semifinal to reach the historic final.

The opening set ended 54-54, giving both teams one point. Korea then pushed ahead in the second, but crucial 10s from Ankita and Kumkum helped India level the match 2-2. India seized control in the third set. After Korea struggled with three consecutive 8s, India capitalised, with Kumkum delivering a decisive 10 to secure the set and take a 4-2 lead. The fourth set remained tense. Korea opened with 9, 9 and 10, while India initially faltered with two 8s. However, Kirti and Ankita responded with 9s before Kumkum again produced a crucial 10.



India win sepaktakraw bronze after Japan defeat



NAGOYA: India's men's quadrant secured a bronze medal in sepaktakraw at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games after losing 0-2 to Japan in the semifinal at Nagoya City Mizuho Park Gymnasium on Friday.

Malemnganba Singh Sorokhaibam, Ram Kumar Sharma, Bobby Kumar and Akash Yumnam went down 12-15, 13-15 against Japan's Yuki Sato, Ryota Haruhara, Wataru Narawa and Yota Ichikawa in two closely fought games. Lokhon Singh Elangbam and Tekong Arun were the substitutes. The medal is India's third in sepaktakraw at the Asian Games. India previously won bronze in the men's team regu at the 2018 Jakarta Games and a women's team regu bronze at the 2022 Hangzhou Games. India topped Group A after winning all three matches, including a notable victory over World Cup champions Myanmar. They also defeated Vietnam and Laos to reach the semifinals and guarantee a medal.

Ankush Panghal strikes gold as India takes six medals

Indian boxers finish campaign with three golds and three bronzes

NISHIO: Ankush Panghal clinched the men's 80kg gold medal with a commanding 4-0 victory over South Korea's Minseong Kim at the Nishio Gymnasium, bringing India's Asian Games boxing campaign to a strong close.

Ankush dominated from the opening bell, winning the first round 4-1 before producing a superior 5-0 performance in the second with sharp combinations and counter-punches. He maintained his defensive discipline in the third, taking it 4-1 to seal the contest. Four judges scored the bout 30-26 for Ankush, while one had it 28-28. Kim was also docked a point for a warning in the opening round.

India finished with six boxing medals three gold and three bronze. Parveen Hooda and Lovlina Borgohain had earlier secured gold.

Parveen defeated Chinese Taipei's Nien-chin Che 3-2 in a closely fought final. After winning the opening round 5-0, she lost the second by the same margin



before taking the decider 3-2. She became the third Indian woman to win Asian Games boxing gold, after MC Mary Kom and Lovlina. Lovlina, celebrating her 29th birthday on Friday, defeated China's Ziyi Bao 5-0 in the 75kg final. The Tokyo Olympics bronze

medallist improved on her 2022 Asian Games silver. India's bronze medallists were Kapil Pokhariya (90kg), Narender Berwal (+90kg) and Priya Ghanghas (60kg). India fielded 11 boxers. Sakshi Chaudhary, Preeti Pawar and Jadumani Singh exited in earlier

rounds, while Sachin Siwach lost in the quarterfinals and Sumit Kundu in the pre-quarterfinals. India's medal haul underlined the depth of its boxing contingent, with the gold-winning performances from Ankush, Parveen and Lovlina providing a strong finish to the country's campaign. The results also reflected the value of sustained preparation, tactical awareness and composure under pressure throughout the competition. Indian fighters displayed confidence against varied styles, adapting their approaches as bouts progressed and making effective use of timing, movement and scoring opportunities. The performances are expected to provide valuable experience to younger members of the squad as they continue developing on the international stage. Coaches and support staff played an important role in helping athletes maintain focus between bouts, manage demanding schedules and execute carefully prepared game plans. The campaign offered encouraging signs for Indian boxing ahead of future major championships.

Portugal stay perfect as Germany earn Klopp win

NEW DELHI: Portugal maintained their perfect start to the UEFA Nations League with a 4-2 victory over Denmark, while Germany secured their first win under new coach Jurgen Klopp by beating Serbia 2-0 in Munich. The Netherlands also rallied from 2-0 down to draw 2-2 with Greece.

Portugal moved six points clear at the top of Group A4 after winning all three matches. Joao Cancelo opened the scoring before Mikkel Damsgaard equalised. Goncalo Ramos restored Portugal's advantage, but Rasmus Hojlund levelled for Denmark in the 53rd minute. Vitinha then put Portugal ahead again with a header before Joao Felix completed the victory on the counterattack. In Munich, Klopp claimed his first victory



in his third match as Germany coach. Tom Bischof opened the scoring after Florian Wirtz had struck the post, before Wirtz doubled the lead after the break with a composed finish. Germany had previously drawn 1-1 with the Netherlands and lost 1-0 to Greece. The win moved them to four points in Group A2. Greece appeared set for another major result after Fotis Ioannidis scored and set up Giorgos Masouras as the hosts led 2-0 at half-time.

Irani Cup: 'Matter of great joy', says BCCI chief Mithun Manhas

SRINAGAR: BCCI President Mithun Manhas described the return of high-profile cricket to the Valley after nearly four decades as a "matter of great joy", expressing hope that Jammu and Kashmir will host more domestic fixtures and eventually international matches.

The Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium is hosting the Irani Cup between Ranji Trophy champions Jammu and Kashmir and Rest of India, marking the return of a match of this stature to Srinagar nearly 40 years after India played Australia in an ODI there in 1986.

Manhas said the BCCI would fully support the Jammu and Kashmir Cricket Association (JKCA) in developing facilities and bringing bigger matches to the region. He also called for



infrastructure beyond Srinagar and Jammu, including grounds and stadiums in the Chenab Valley and Rajouri-Poonch.

He cited Baramulla-born pacer Auqib Nabi's recent India ODI call-up as proof that talent from the region can reach the highest level. Manhas urged youngsters to remain sincere, work hard and believe in their potential. Reflecting on the Irani Cup opener, he said J&K's

Ranji Trophy triumph reflected growing talent. J&K bowled out Rest of India for 237 after choosing to field, with Sunil Kumar and Lone Nasir Muzaffar taking three wickets each.

Rest of India responded late, reducing J&K to 21/2 at stumps. The hosts therefore trail by 216 runs, with Manhas saying the next morning's session will be crucial in determining the match's direction.

Lovlina Borgohain reveals thoughts of quitting boxing

Asian Games champion says rediscovering joy helped revive her career

NISHIO: Lovlina Borgohain revealed she considered quitting boxing after the Paris Olympics, where she failed to win a medal following her Tokyo Olympics bronze. On Friday, the 29-year-old returned to the top by winning Asian Games gold, becoming only the second Indian woman boxer after MC Mary Kom to achieve the feat.

Lovlina said the period after Paris was emotionally difficult, as she struggled with the disappointment of giving her best without getting the desired result. She eventually realised she was boxing because she loved the sport, rather than simply chasing

medals. "I started boxing on a fresh note. I enjoy everything. I just enjoy my game now. That's why I got the result," she said after her victory.

The gold also helped Lovlina improve on the silver she won at the 2022 Hangzhou Asian Games. She had earlier completed her major medal collection with silver at the 2026 Commonwealth Games, adding to her Olympic bronze, Asian Games silver and World Championships gold.

Lovlina said she entered the Aichi-Nagoya Games determined to change the colour of her Asian Games medal.

She credited her coaches, the government and everyone who supported her journey for helping her achieve the breakthrough.

The gold came on her 29th birthday, making the achievement even more special. After the victory, she celebrated with a cake-cutting ceremony and described the medal as a major birthday gift.

Lovlina said she was proud to win the medal for India and grateful for the blessings and support she received. Her triumph marked a significant comeback after the disappointment of Paris and added another major title to her career.



Drishyam 3 opens strongly, Targets Rs 50 cr on Friday

Ajay Devgn and Tabu thriller records strong advances before opening weekend

Ajay Devgn returns as Vijay Salgaonkar in Drishyam 3: The Conclusion, the final chapter of the popular Hindi thriller franchise, which opened in theatres on Friday, October 2, amid substantial buzz and strong audience interest.

Early estimates indicate a solid opening for the Abhishek Pathak directorial. According to Sacnilk, the film had collected Rs 28.13 crore net in India from 7,431 shows by 2pm on Friday, placing it on course for a strong opening day.

The film also entered theatres with significant momentum from advance bookings. Across seven days



currently open, Drishyam 3 has recorded Rs 60.17 crore gross in India, including blocked seats. Excluding blocked seats, the advance gross stands at Rs 49.29 crore, with around 18.02 lakh tickets sold across 51,570 shows. Friday accounts for the largest share, generating

Rs 31.65 crore gross through advance sales, or Rs 27.92 crore excluding blocked seats, from approximately 8.82 lakh tickets across 16,125 shows.

Interest remains strong for the opening weekend. Saturday advance bookings stand at Rs 14.77 crore, while Sunday has

reached Rs 11 crore. Advance collections for Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday currently stand at Rs 93.87 lakh, Rs 91.88 lakh and Rs 86.37 lakh, respectively.

The October 1 premiere collected Rs 3.18 lakh from 84 shows. For Wednesday, October 7, the film has sold 52,606 tickets across 1,898 shows, with advance occupancy at 12%.

The third instalment marks the conclusion of the Hindi franchise, with Ajay Devgn reprising his acclaimed role alongside Tabu. Early reactions have praised the performances, suspense and climax. With the weekend ahead, sustained audience response will determine the film's theatrical run.

Nushrratt Bharuccha to undergo spine surgery



Bollywood actress Nushrratt Bharuccha suffered a spinal fracture following an accident during her work-cum-holiday trip to Bali and is currently hospitalised there, her team said. An official statement said she remains under medical observation and will undergo spine surgery after further evaluation. Arrangements are being made to bring her back to Mumbai by air

ambulance, where she will receive further treatment. Her team said her health is the immediate priority and her work commitments over the next few weeks are likely to be affected as she rests and recovers. It also requested privacy and thanked fans for their concern and wishes. Nushrratt began her career with television shows including Kitty Party and Seven before making her film debut with Jai Santoshi Maa.

Kabir Bedi recalls mother's arrest during freedom struggle

Actor Kabir Bedi remembered his mother, Freda Bedi, and her contribution to India's freedom movement on Gandhi Jayanti, sharing her story alongside photographs from Mahatma Gandhi's historic Sabarmati Ashram in Ahmedabad.



The Khoon Bhari Maang actor said his mother was a hand-picked satyagrahi of Gandhi and participated in peaceful protests against British rule. Recalling her role, Kabir said Freda led demonstrations in his hometown of Dera Baba Nanak in Punjab, for which she was arrested and jailed.

He said her association with Gandhi's movement gave him "very special reverence" for the freedom leader. Kabir also shared photographs from his visit to Sabarmati Ashram

during an earlier trip to Ahmedabad and extended wishes for "love and peace" on Gandhi Jayanti. Freda Bedi was a British-born writer and freedom activist who supported India's independence movement, participated in non-violent protests and was imprisoned during British rule. She was chosen by Gandhi to participate in the freedom struggle and died on March 26, 1977. Gandhi Jayanti is observed on October 2 to mark Gandhi's birth anniversary.

Florence Pugh says East of Eden expanded horizons

Hollywood actress Florence Pugh has credited her role as Cathy Ames in East of Eden with helping her grow as an actor and explore new creative possibilities.

The 30-year-old actress stars in the limited-series adaptation of John Steinbeck's acclaimed novel. Speaking to Netflix's Tudum, Pugh recalled reading the script in 2020 while seeking roles that would challenge her; strengthen her craft and broaden her artistic range.



The series, written and executive produced by Zoe Kazan, also gave Pugh an opportunity to become involved creatively beyond acting. She said Kazan invited her to join the project not only as a performer but as part of the creative journey, describing the experience as a major confidence boost.

Pugh said the role allowed her to "be bigger and better" while encouraging her to contribute to the project from the ground up. She also

described playing Cathy as both exciting and daunting, particularly while exploring the character's motivations, choices and transformation.

The actress said the project brought together several elements she was looking for: a compelling character; opportunities to grow as a performer and the chance to participate creatively behind the scenes.

She praised the experience of working closely with Kazan and said the role opened new avenues for her artistic development.

Salman Khan appears at Prem Keetanu screening

Salman Khan grabbed attention at the special screening of Prem Keetanu in Mumbai on Thursday night, extending his support to actors Veer Pahariya and Aafiya Sayed ahead of the film's theatrical release.

The Bollywood superstar made a stylish appearance in a light blue shirt, white trousers and sunglasses. A viral video from the event showed Salman warmly embracing Veer and Aafiya and wishing the young actors success.



Another widely discussed moment captured Salman patiently waiting for his turn to pose for paparazzi photographs.

The screening also saw several celebrities turning up to support the film's team.

Jacqueline Fernandez attended the event, while Anup Soni, Sakshi Malik and

Anusha Dandekar were also spotted at the venue.

Directed by Apoorv Singh Karki, Prem Keetanu is a romantic comedy-drama and the official Hindi adaptation of Malayalam hit Premalu. The film released across Indian theatres on October 2, 2026.

Its trailer presents a coming-of-age story centred on relationships, friendship and experiences associated with young adulthood.

The film is co-presented by Phars Film in association with Bhavana Studios and produced by Gaurav Verma under Avaniika Films. The gathering created a lively atmosphere as members of the entertainment industry came together to celebrate the new project.

The presence of established personalities added further visibility to the occasion, drawing considerable interest from photographers and fans outside the venue.

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THE SAVERA TIMES

Student groups protest against CEC over electoral rolls

Protesters demand action, citing concerns over SIR and voting rights

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: Student and youth organisations staged a protest at Jantar Mantar on Friday, raising concerns over the Election Commission of India's functioning and the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The demonstration was held on Gandhi Jayanti. The mobilisation included the All India Students Association (AISA), Students Federation of India (SFI), National Students Union of India (NSUI) and Indian Youth Congress (IYC), among other groups. Organisers demanded action against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, including his resignation or impeachment, alleging that



Security personnel detain DYFI and SFI activists during their protest near Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Friday

the handling of electoral rolls had raised concerns over voters' rights and the electoral process. The Election Commission has

rejected allegations of wrongdoing and maintained that its decisions were taken through due process. The protest came amid height-

ened security across central Delhi. Authorities imposed restrictions around the New Delhi area, while several Metro stations also faced temporary entry and exit restrictions as officials prepared for the demonstrations. The protesters particularly focused on the SIR exercise and electoral-roll changes, arguing that the process required greater scrutiny to protect voting rights. The demonstration added to the ongoing public debate over electoral-roll revisions and the functioning of the poll panel. Separately, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) announced a campaign seeking Kumar's resignation, with its October 2 programme beginning in Mumbai.

AAP leaders detained during protest

NEW DELHI: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leaders and workers were detained during a protest at Jantar Mantar on Friday while demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. The detainees were taken to Fatehpur Beri Police Station in south Delhi. Former Delhi Chief Minister Atishi, among those detained, said protesters were not afraid of police and would continue their campaign, alleging that voters' rights were being undermined. AAP spokesperson Anurag Dhanda also accused the authorities of targeting protesters while demanding action against the



CEC. The protest came amid Opposition allegations of "vote theft" and claims concerning the functioning of the Election Commission. A media report had also highlighted alleged differences within the poll panel. AAP Delhi chief Saurabh Bharadwaj and MLA Jarnail Singh participated in a protest march. Bharadwaj demanded reforms in

the Election Commission and withdrawal of alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise. Singh alleged that two Election Commissioners had exposed the CEC and called for legal action and his dismissal. AAP MLA Sanjeev Jha also accused the BJP and Kumar of conspiring against democracy and demanded immediate legal action. The allegations were made by AAP leaders during the protest. The Election Commission has maintained that its processes follow established legal and procedural requirements.

Ghaziabad police bust cyber gang linked Canada

GHAZIABAD: Ghaziabad Crime Branch has busted a cybercrime gang allegedly involved in sextortion and investment fraud, arresting four people after a complaint by a Canadian NRI woman. Police said the gang had defrauded victims across states of about Rs 6.58 crore. The accused were identified as Faisal, Aman, Hammad and Faizan. Police said they created fake Facebook profiles, lured victims into video calls, recorded objectionable footage and used AI to create videos for blackmail. The gang allegedly demanded \$50,000 from the Canadian woman, threatening to circulate the fabricated video.



Four cyber gang accused arrested

Investigators found that the accused purchased bank accounts from others, used them to receive fraud proceeds and shared the money among themselves. Accounts attracting multiple complaints were subsequently abandoned. Police said the gang also targeted victims through fake stock-market investment and trading applications.

Govt approved forest protection reservation for Northern Ridge

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has approved a Phase-I notification to declare 112.328 hectares, or 277.56 acres, in the Northern Ridge as reserved forest under Section 20 of the Indian Forest Act, 1927. The move is aimed at strengthening legal protection for one of the capital's key ecological zones. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta described the Northern Ridge, part of the Aravalli landscape, as an important component of Delhi's natural heritage. She said legal protection would strengthen long-term con-



servation and help the city address environmental challenges. The government said the latest notification takes the total area notified as reserved forest in Delhi to 5,363.169 hectares, or around 13,252.39 acres. It said 5,267.009 hectares had been notified during the tenure of the present government, compared with 96.16 hectares under previous governments. The government had also

277 acres receive legal protection as Delhi expands conservation measures

approved notification of around 400 hectares in the Southern Ridge last month. Gupta said environmental conservation, expanding green cover and tackling pollution needed to progress together. The government said more than 73 lakh saplings had been planted in Delhi this year, with plantation continuing under initiatives including 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' and 'Vriksh Rath'.

DDA audits 736 parks, steps up security measures

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has completed a safety audit of all 736 parks under its jurisdiction following the gang rape at Aastha Kunj Park and directions from Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu. The parks have been classified as high, medium and low risk, with 190, 258 and 288 parks respectively. Security measures are being prioritised in the 190 high-risk parks to prevent antisocial activity and improve safety for women and children. The audit found 520 parks requiring additional lighting, with work started in 231 and completed in 106 during the past week.

High-risk parks to get CCTV, lighting, patrols and stronger security



Delhi Police patrolling parks

Security infrastructure is also being strengthened. Broken or open gates at 163 parks are being replaced with lockable gates, while boundary wall and grille repairs have been completed in 233 of 399 identified parks.

MCD councillors seek tougher waste rules, enforcement

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: A special meeting of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) House on the Solid Waste Management By-Laws 2026 on Friday saw councillors push for stronger waste collection, segregation, transportation and disposal systems. Chief Engineer Ajay Agarwal briefed members on provisions of the proposed by-laws. Councillors stressed public participation and better implementation. BJP councillor Yogita Singh suggested using artificial intelligence and technology to determine suitable waste-management systems for different colonies. She said wet and dry waste often gets mixed during



collection despite household segregation and called for training private-agency workers. She also proposed specialised rickshaws with separate compartments to prevent spillage in narrow lanes and multi-storey areas. BJP councillor Dhamveer Sharma said designated dumping spots in wards continue to attract vegetable peels, leftover food and rotis despite repeated cleaning. He suggested closed cabinets or dedicated collection facilities and proposed increasing the fine for open dumping

from Rs 200 to Rs 10,000, with action based on photographs. Councillor Manisha Singh said segregation was often lost during collection and transportation, calling for smaller vehicles in congested areas and scientific separation of household hazardous waste. DEMS chairman Sandeep Kapoor stressed public participation and strict enforcement against market shopkeepers dumping waste on streets. He said around 13,000 tonnes of waste is collected from wards daily and called for identifying bulk waste generators. Kapoor said the target is to compost waste locally from at least 3,000 bulk waste generators this year, reducing both waste volume.

Gandhi Jayanti 2026



President Droupadi Murmu and Union Minister Manohar Lal Khattar attend Sarva Dharma Prarthana at Raj Ghat on Gandhi Jayanti, in New Delhi on Friday.

CM Rekha Gupta joins Azadpur cleanliness drive

Chief minister stresses clear accountability for maintaining cleaner civic spaces

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta joined a cleanliness drive at Azadpur on Friday under the 'Seva Mera Yogdan' campaign, urging citizens to contribute towards keeping the capital clean. The event was held on Mahatma Gandhi's birth anniversary. Gupta said she chose the location to highlight persistent sanitation problems and clarify responsibility among civic authorities. She said the area near the back gate of the market frequently accumulated large quantities of garbage, while the Keshav Puram and



Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta joined at cleanliness drive

Civil Lines zones had differed over whether it fell within their jurisdictions. Calling for clear accountability, Gupta said officials must

identify responsibility at every level and work systematically to improve cleanliness. She said conditions had improved over the past year, with

reduced dust and roads no longer sinking during the season, and credited the PWD for its work. She also said cleanliness could not be treated merely as an administrative responsibility and called for greater public participation. According to Gupta, residents, civic bodies and government departments must work together to sustain improvements and prevent garbage from accumulating at vulnerable locations. In a post on X, Gupta described the cleanliness drive as a community-service activity and said cleanliness should become a civic duty and a daily habit.

AI command centre to track pollution sources across Capital

THE SAVERA TIMES NEWS NETWORK

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) on Thursday launched an Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC) at Shastri Park for round-the-clock monitoring of pollution sources using artificial intelligence, CCTV cameras and GPS tracking. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated the facility at the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation IT Park under the Seva Sankalp Campaign. Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa, MLA Arvinder Singh Lovely and other officials attended.



Gupta said the centre would follow a "detect, analyse, act, verify" approach, linking real-time pollution monitoring with field enforcement. The ICCC will identify pollution hotspots and violations and alert concerned departments for action. More than 700 construction sites covering over 500 square metres will be monitored through AI and CCTV. Sirsa said alerts would be sent

New centre will monitor construction sites, hotspots and violations around-the-clock

to departments and site owners when PM10 levels rise at monitored locations. During winter, 78 sub-division-level teams will conduct monitoring and enforcement. GPS-enabled vehicles will track their movements, while body cameras will provide live feeds to the command centre. GPS-linked mechanical road sweepers will also be monitored for location, operating hours, distance covered and cleaning of designated areas.

Drug consignment worth crores seized at IGI Airport

Indian passenger arrested after suspected contraband found following customs profiling

NEW DELHI: Customs officials at Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport have seized 4.43 kg of suspected ganja, valued at around Rs 1.55 crore, from an Indian passenger arriving from Hanoi, Vietnam, officials said.

According to the Customs Department, the passenger arrived at Terminal 3 on September 29. Based on profiling, Customs officers intercepted him and diverted him to the Green Channel for examination.

During the examination, officials allegedly recovered 4.43 kg of suspected ganja from his possession. The contraband was subsequently seized under Section 43(A) of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985.

The passenger was arrested



During the examination of his travel bag, officers found four polythene pouches containing suspected marijuana

under Section 43(B) of the NDPS Act, Customs officials said. Further legal proceedings have been initiated in accordance with the provisions of the law.

The seizure followed targeted passenger profiling at the airport,

with Customs personnel intercepting the passenger after identifying him for further examination.

Officials said the suspected contraband was valued at approximately Rs 1.55 crore. The case highlights continued checks on

passengers arriving from international destinations as part of efforts to prevent the smuggling of narcotic substances through the airport.

The Customs Department has seized the suspected ganja and arrested the passenger under the relevant provisions of the NDPS Act. Further investigation is underway to establish the circumstances surrounding the alleged smuggling attempt and identify any possible links to a wider network.

Authorities continue to conduct passenger profiling and baggage checks at IGI Airport to detect attempts to transport prohibited substances. The passenger's identity was not disclosed in the information released by the Customs Department.

Rs 9 crore development plan launched for Ramphal Chowk

NEW DELHI: Development work has formally begun to transform Ramphal Chowk, a major commercial and residential hub of Palam Assembly constituency, and surrounding areas, with infrastructure projects worth around Rs 9 crore planned.

Regional MP Ramveer Singh Bidhuri and Palam MLA Kuldeep Solanki laid the foundation stone for the projects aimed at improving basic amenities for residents, pedestrians and local businesses.

Under the plan, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will construct a new road between Brahma Apartment and CCRT at an estimated cost of Rs 7.5 crore. Footpaths will also be developed along the road to improve pedestrian movement.

The project includes extensive repair and strengthening of DDA drains to address waterlogging, a persistent problem during the monsoon. The planned infrastruc-



Dwarka's Ramphal Chowk will be free from traffic jams and waterlogging.

ture upgrades are also expected to improve traffic movement around the busy commercial area.

Residents who have faced prolonged sewerage and drinking-water problems are also expected to get relief. New sewer lines will be laid in areas without existing sewerage connections. The Delhi Jal Board has also been directed to lay new and stronger water pipelines across the locality

to improve drinking-water supply and prevent shortages.

Ramphal Chowk is among the busiest markets in Palam, attracting thousands of visitors every day. Road widening and improved traffic management under the development plan are expected to ease congestion and reduce frequent traffic jams.

Officials said the combined infrastructure works are aimed

Police bust extortion network

NEW DELHI: The Special Task Force (STF) of North Delhi Police has busted an India-Dubai network allegedly demanding Rs 1 crore in extortion from Delhi businessmen in the name of the Goldy Brar gang, arresting three key accused.

Police said two Delhi-based businessmen received threats from the same UAE number, with each allegedly being asked to pay Rs 1 crore. Shooters were also allegedly hired to carry out attacks, but police foiled the planned shootings.

The case began on September 16 when Roop Nagar businessman Praveen Jain received three missed calls around 8.15pm. His son Ayush later received a call from a UAE number from a person claiming to be associated with Goldy Brar, demanding Rs 1 crore and threatening consequences if the money was not paid. An FIR was registered at Roop Nagar police station on September 17.

Technical investigation traced an IP address and VPS-based

Three arrested after businessmen allegedly threatened over Rs 1 crore each



communication system linked to France, while further leads pointed to the UAE. Interrogation of suspects in Dehradun and Karnal led police to Arif, alias Pistol, from Shamli.

Police alleged Arif offered money to Arish in Dubai to make the threatening call and instructed him to speak in Haryanvi. Investigators identified Mubarak alias Gullu of Titwara as the alleged main conspirator, who reportedly arranged accommodation

for shooters in Kirari. Arif was arrested in Ahmedabad, while wanted shooter Nawab Ali alias Sonij was apprehended from a moving train near Rewari with RPF assistance.

On September 19, the same UAE number allegedly threatened Rohini businessman Manoj Malik's brother, demanding Rs 1 crore within 48 hours. An FIR was registered at Vijay Vihar police station. Investigation continues to identify Dubai-based associates.

Birth Anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi and Lal Bahadur Shastri



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, along with Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, Union Ministers Kiren Rijiju, Rajnath Singh, JP Nadda, BJP National President Nitin Nabin, and Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, pose for a group photo after paying tributes to Mahatma Gandhi and Lal Bahadur Shastri on their birth anniversary at Samvidhan Sadan, in New Delhi on Friday.

Farmers perform havan at Ghazipur border to mark 2018 farmer protest

GHAZIABAD: More than 300 farmers, including a large number of women, gathered at Kisan Kranti Gate on the Ghazipur border on Friday to mark the anniversary of the 2018 Kisan Kranti Yatra. Under the Bharatiya Kisan Union (BKU) Tikait, farmers organised a havan to remember the protest and events surrounding it.

Police deployed a heavy force at the border ahead of the programme. According to BKU members, farmers had undertaken the Kisan Kranti Yatra from Haridwar to Delhi in 2018 and planned to reach Mahatma Gandhi's memorial. They alleged that police stopped them at the Delhi border using lathi charge and tear gas, affecting a large number of participants.



Farmer leaders said following the incident, Rakesh Tikait announced that the Ghazipur border would be known as Kisan Kranti Gate. Since then, farmers have gathered there every October 2 to commemorate the movement and remember those events through programmes including havans.

BKU Ghaziabad district president Vijendra Singh said farmers had not forgotten what happened during the 2018 movement. He said the annual gathering was intended to remind the government that farmers remained important to the country.

Singh also alleged that the government had failed to

Over 300 farmers gather as BKU Tikait recalls Kisan Kranti Yatra

fulfil several promises made to farmers and said many demands remained pending. He said farmers were discussing a future strategy to address their issues.

According to Singh, under the leadership of BKU national spokesperson Rakesh Tikait, preparations are being made for a larger movement on farmers' issues in the coming period. Friday's programme, however, focused on commemorating the 2018 Kisan Kranti Yatra and keeping its memories alive.

Capital posts five-year low September AQI average

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded its lowest average Air Quality Index (AQI) for September in five years at 102, with officials reporting improvement across several key air-quality indicators. Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa highlighted the figures, saying the trend was encouraging but "the work is far from over."

According to a Press Information Bureau report, September's average AQI was 102 in 2026, compared with 105 in 2025 and 2024, 108 in 2023 and 104 in 2022. From January to September, Delhi recorded 194 days with daily average AQI below 200, the highest in the corresponding five-year period. The figure was 187 in 2025, 188 in 2024, 193 in 2023 and 146 in 2022.

The number of "Poor to



Delhi Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa

Severe+" days fell to 79, compared with 86 each in 2025 and 2024, 80 in 2023 and 127 in 2022. Average PM2.5 concentration stood at 69 µg/m³, jointly the lowest since 2022. The figures cover January-September, with data through September 28 for PM2.5, and reflect a broader improving trend.

Sirsa said the government

Delhi saw 194 cleaner-air days as poor-to-severe days fell sharply

was treating pollution as a year-round challenge, focusing on continuous monitoring, enforcement and ground-level action. He also criticised the previous AAP government, alleging it prioritised publicity and advertisements over combating pollution. The minister said the Delhi government was working with concerned agencies to tackle pollution at every level, with cleaner air and public health as stated priorities. The PIB said the Commission for Air Quality Management would intensify coordinated measures to prevent, control and reduce pollution in Delhi-NCR in the coming days.

Hauz Khas community dog wins final by nearly 40,000 votes

NEW DELHI: Gola, a 75-kg community dog from Hauz Khas, has been crowned Delhi's fattest dog after winning the final of the unusual 'Fat Dogs of Delhi' contest by 39,904 votes.

Also known as Kebab or Rajpal Singh, Gola was a popular community dog from SDA Market. She continued in the contest posthumously after dying during the campaign. In the final, she defeated Googoo from Saket.

The contest began with 64 dogs from across Delhi, with supporters promoting their neighbourhood favourites through Instagram campaigns, posters, memes, reels and appeals for votes. The grand finale was held on Wednesday.

Voting took place both online and through physical polling booths, allowing residents to participate beyond social media. Booths were set up at cafes in Vasant Vihar, Kamla Nagar and



Gola had continued competing posthumously after her death during the contest

Punjabi Bagh, where voters cast ballots and had their fingers marked after voting.

The polling attracted people across age groups, including youngsters and elderly residents. Some supporters arrived carrying campaign material for their preferred dogs, creating an elec-

tion-like atmosphere around the light-hearted competition.

Googoo reached the final after a closely contested semi-final against Tara, while Gola's supporters rallied behind her through successive rounds despite her death.

Organisers said the event, which began as a playful celebration of chubby community dogs, developed a strong following across neighbourhoods. Animal-welfare groups and volunteers also used the campaign to highlight issues concerning community dogs.

The organiser said the campaign's reach would support animal welfare through donations for shelters, food, beds and collars. The contest concluded with Gola emerging as the winner, turning an unusual citywide competition into a celebration of community dogs and public participation.

Capital launches cleanliness campaign with anthem on Gandhi Jayanti in Adarsh Nagar

Chief Minister urges citizens to make cleanliness part of daily life

NEW DELHI: Cleanliness drives were organised across Delhi on Gandhi Jayanti under the "Participate in Cleanliness, Clean India, Develop India" campaign, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launching the initiative and a new cleanliness anthem at an event in Adarsh Nagar.

A separate cleanliness drive was held on Vikas Marg in East Delhi, where Union Minister of State and BJP Delhi president Harsh Malhotra participated in Shramdaan. Vishwas Nagar MLA Om Prakash Sharma and Laxmi Nagar MLA Abhay Verma also attended. The programme was chaired by East Zone president Yashpal Singh.

BJP councillors and Municipal Corporation of Delhi workers and party workers joined the voluntary cleaning exercise, urging



Delhi BJP State President Harsh Malhotra in the cleanliness program

residents to keep public places clean and make cleanliness part of their daily routine.

Malhotra said Mahatma Gandhi had attached great importance to cleanliness and described the campaign as an effort to reinforce that message among citizens.

He said cleanliness should not remain limited to a one-day exercise but become a regular part of everyday life.

The campaign emphasised public participation in maintaining cleaner neighbourhoods and public spaces. Malhotra said

the involvement of citizens was essential to sustaining cleanliness efforts and improving civic surroundings.

Public representatives, municipal officials and activists participated in similar cleanliness programmes organised across different districts on Gandhi Jayanti. The campaign sought to encourage residents to take greater responsibility for public spaces and strengthen collective participation in cleanliness initiatives.

The launch of the cleanliness anthem was also aimed at creating wider public awareness and encouraging people to adopt cleaner habits. Organisers reiterated that sustained citizen participation would be essential to maintaining the momentum of the campaign beyond Gandhi Jayanti.

Sanjay Singh stages Parliament sit-in, demands CEC resignation

AAP MP alleges vote deletions, seeks election chief's resignation Friday

NEW DELHI: Aam Aadmi Party Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh staged a sit-in near Parliament on Friday after police stopped him while he was proceeding to the complex amid protests over alleged electoral irregularities.

He later entered Parliament and resumed the protest before Mahatma Gandhi's statue, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Singh said he wanted to enter Parliament to raise the issue of alleged "vote theft" and questioned why police had stopped him despite being an MP.

He said the police action prevented him from discharging his parliamentary duties.



AAP MP Sanjay Singh

Speaking on Gandhi Jayanti, Singh alleged that Prime Minister Narendra

Modi and Kumar were responsible for the deletion of 13.37 crore names from electoral rolls. He alleged that similar irregularities had helped the BJP gain power in state assemblies.

These claims are allegations by Singh and have not been established as fact.

Singh also alleged that people protesting against the issue were being prevented from speaking and that arrests were being made.

He invoked Gandhi's role in India's freedom movement and appealed to citizens to oppose what he described as "vote theft" and authoritarianism.

The protest came amid demonstrations in Delhi

demanding Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. More than 700 protesters, including AAP leaders and student activists, were detained during Friday's demonstrations, according to reports. The Election Commission has rejected allegations of wrongdoing related to the electoral-roll exercise.

Singh urged people across the country to raise their voices against alleged electoral irregularities and called for united action.

His sit-in at the Gandhi statue followed the police intervention as he attempted to proceed towards Parliament during the protest.

Truck crushes 18-year-old youth, driver absconds

NEW DELHI: An 18-year-old youth, Kartik, was crushed to death by a speeding truck in Rama Vihar around 11pm on Thursday. Kartik was riding his scooter when the truck hit him, and its rear wheel ran over him. He died at the spot.

Residents and family members gathered after the accident, with angry locals allegedly damaging the truck's windows. The crowd caused a traffic jam before police arrived and restored order. A forensic team collected evidence, while police sent the body for post-mortem.

The truck driver fled and remains absconding. Police registered a case and are examining CCTV footage to identify him and determine the accident's circumstances. Kartik's mother said he was her only son and demanded justice. His father, who was called to the scene, found him dead.

IIT-Delhi panel gets second extension

NEW DELHI: The committee constituted by the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Delhi, to inquire into the death of MSc Physics student Rishikesh Kumar has received a second extension and will now submit its report by October 10.

The panel, led by Delhi High Court judge Justice Mukta Gupta, was initially given two weeks to complete the inquiry after being reconstituted. Its deadline was first extended to September 30 and has now been extended by 10 days.

An official said the committee sought time due to circumstances arising during the inquiry. The panel was originally headed by Uttarakhand DGP Ashok Kumar, who later recused himself, following which Justice Gupta was appointed chairperson.

The committee includes



Justice Gupta, AIIMS New Delhi Psychiatry department head Prof Pratap Sharan, four student representatives and IIT-Delhi Registrar Atul Vyas, who serves as secretary and convener.

The panel will interact with students, faculty and officials, examine protocols and processes, and recommend measures based on its findings.

The inquiry followed Kumar's death after he fell from the sixth floor of IIT-Delhi's Lecture Hall Complex in August. The incident prompted student protests demanding an independent probe.

Farmers from 81 villages challenge encroacher tag

NOIDA: Farmers from 81 villages raised land and civic issues at a Bharatiya Kisan Sanghatana meeting in Sarfabad on Friday, objecting to being labelled "encroachers" by the Noida Development Authority. The meeting was chaired by Pappu Pehlwan.

Organisation national president Rajendra Yadav alleged that local farmers had never directly transferred their land to the authority. He said the land was first transferred to the district administration, which subsequently handed it to the Noida Authority. Farmers, he said, continue to occupy land for which they have not received compensation, while their names were removed from records and replaced with the authority's name.

Yadav said the district

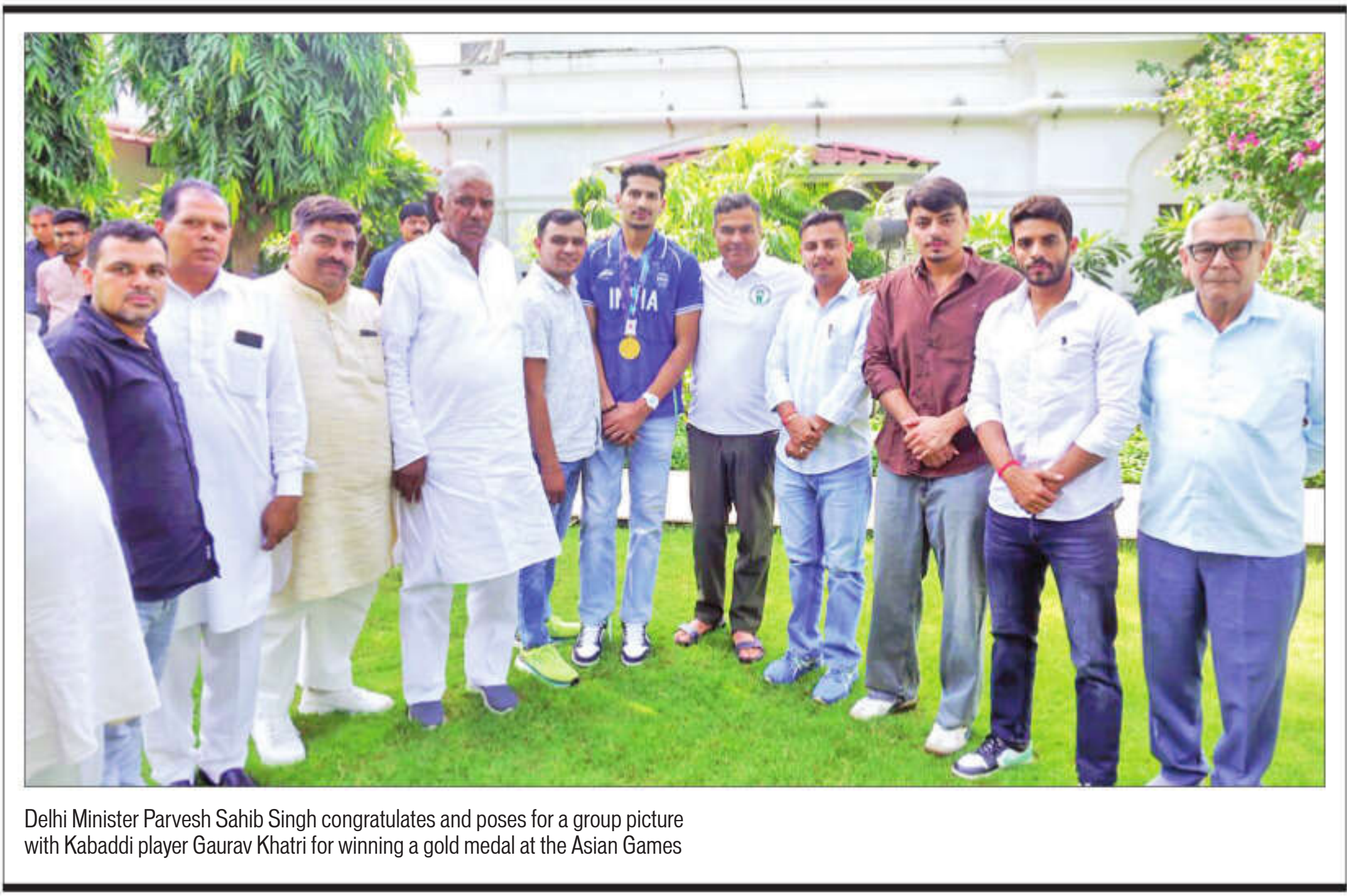


administration should be held responsible for the transfer instead of treating farmers as encroachers. He also demanded steps to resolve the villages' longstanding civic problems and provide greater clarity over land ownership.

Farmers particularly sought permanent sewer and water connections. Metropolitan pres-

ident Deepu Yadav questioned why permanent connections could not be provided when many villages already have functioning water and sewer systems. He said residents of all the affected villages were seeking permanent connections.

Farmer Gajendra said the focus should be on regularising existing settlements.



Delhi Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh congratulates and poses for a group picture with Kabaddi player Gaurav Khatri for winning a gold medal at the Asian Games

Five industrial projects bring Rs 450 crore investment

GREATER NOIDA: The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) has allotted five industrial plots for projects involving a combined investment of Rs 450.15 crore and expected employment for 4,300 people. Three of the projects are for readymade garment manufacturing.

YEIDA CEO Rakesh Kumar Singh said allotment letters for the projects were handed over during the Uttar Pradesh International Trade Show (UPITS) by Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.

Perfect Pack Ltd has received four acres in Sector 8D. The company will invest Rs 110 crore to manufacture corrugated boxes and employ 450 people.

Symplast India Pvt Ltd has been allotted three acres in Sec-



tor 8D. Its project, involving an investment of Rs 76.70 crore, will manufacture moulded products for the automobile sector and create 300 jobs.

Sahu Exports Pvt Ltd has received 2.5 acres in Sector 29 for a readymade garment unit, which is expected to employ 1,050 people. The project accounts for an investment of around Rs 74.21

crore.

C&R Textiles Pvt Ltd has been allotted four acres in Sector 29 for garment manufacturing. The company will invest Rs 102.26 crore and provide employment to 2,000 people.

Sabs Export International Pvt Ltd has also received four acres in Sector 29. It will invest Rs 86.98 crore and employ 500 people.

Minor held after labourer killed in Sultanpuri

NEW DELHI: A 40-year-old labourer, identified as Shiv Singh, was allegedly killed during an altercation in Delhi's Sultanpuri area, with police arresting a minor in connection with the case.

According to preliminary information, an argument while the two were passing through a street escalated, after which the accused allegedly attacked Singh with a knife and slit his throat. Singh died following the attack.

The accused allegedly fled the scene after the incident. Police reached the spot after receiving information and began investigating the circumstances surrounding the killing. Singh's body was taken to the mortuary for post-mortem examination.

Singh's brother said he received a call about the incident and rushed to the location, where he learned that his brother had been killed.

CM Nayab Singh Saini reviews Gurugram development projects

GURUGRAM: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini chaired a high-level review meeting on Gurugram's development projects on Friday, assessing the progress of major infrastructure works and pending schemes across the city.

The meeting focused on the current status of projects, construction progress and delays, with officials from concerned departments asked to provide updates. Directions are expected on timely completion, quality standards and resolving bottlenecks affecting ongoing works.

Road infrastructure, transportation, water supply, sewerage and drainage projects are among the key areas under review. The meeting is also considering



new development proposals and pending projects in line with Gurugram's growing population, traffic pressure and future infrastructure requirements. The review is aimed at accelerating projects that have faced delays while ensuring that new infrastructure is planned according to the city's expanding needs. Officials are expected to examine implementation timelines and identify areas

requiring administrative intervention.

Industry and Commerce Minister Rao Narbir Singh, Sohna MLA Tejpal Tanwar and Gurugram MLA Mukesh Sharma attended the meeting along with senior officials from relevant departments.

The discussions are expected to provide direction on projects requiring faster execution and administrative approvals.

Govt plans Rs 650 crore bus shelter overhaul across city

NEW DELHI: Around 3,575 bus queue shelters across Delhi are set for redevelopment under a proposed Rs 650-crore project aimed at improving passenger facilities. The project will be implemented through a public-private partnership (PPP) model under the Delhi Transport Infrastructure Development Corporation (DTIDC), with the cost including 20 years of maintenance.

The revamped shelters are planned to feature digital passenger information systems displaying bus routes, numbers and real-time arrival information. Other proposed facilities include weather protection, digital advertising screens, solar panels, LED lighting and panic alarm systems to improve passenger safety.

The initiative is expected to address long-standing problems at bus stops where commuters



often wait in the open during rain and extreme heat. Many shelters are reportedly damaged, while several locations lack proper seating or roofs altogether.

According to available information, Delhi has more than

60,000 major bus stops, with over half reportedly in poor condition. The redevelopment plan will also cover locations where existing shelters have damaged roofs or where no shelter currently exists. A project management con-

Around 3,575 shelters will gain digital, safety and weather facilities

sultancy is being appointed to survey, design and oversee redevelopment of the approximately 3,575 selected shelters. A tender has been issued for the process, and the agency chosen will assess conditions along various routes and at bus stops across the capital.

The proposed project is intended to make waiting for buses more predictable through real-time information while improving basic comfort and security. With maintenance incorporated for two decades, authorities are also seeking a longer-term approach to upkeep rather than relying only on initial construction.

Delhi heat persists as rain likely

NEW DELHI: Delhi-NCR is likely to remain dry with clear skies over the next few days, while temperatures stay above normal and air pollution remains a concern. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast similar conditions through the weekend, with rain expected on October 6 and 7.

Safdarjung, Delhi's base station, recorded a maximum temperature of 35.2 degrees Celsius on Thursday, 0.5 degrees above normal. The minimum was 24 degrees, 0.6 degrees above normal. Palam recorded 33.5 degrees, Lodhi Road 35.3 degrees, Ridge 34.4 degrees and Ayanagar 35.6 degrees.

For Friday, the IMD forecast clear skies and sunshine, with the maximum temperature likely to remain between 33 and 35 degrees Celsius and the minimum between 21 and 23 degrees. Northwesterly winds are expected at 15-20 kmph. Similar weather is likely in the coming days, before rain could bring a change on October 6-7.



Dry weather continues as pollution rises ahead of rain next

Meanwhile, pollution levels have remained elevated. According to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), Delhi's average AQI stood at 160 at 7am Friday. Faridabad recorded 148, Gurugram 142, Ghaziabad 135, Greater Noida 129 and Noida 138.

In most parts of Delhi, the AQI

remained between 100 and 200. With warmer-than-normal temperatures and deteriorating air quality, residents may continue to experience uncomfortable conditions until the anticipated rain arrives next week.

The forecast indicates that no immediate relief from heat or pollution is expected before the rain window. Commuters and residents can expect bright mornings, warm afternoons and relatively cooler nights, with weather conditions changing only after the predicted showers.

“An early-morning walk is a blessing for the whole day.”
- Henry David Thoreau



How Better Morning Routines Shape Your Day

From waking up consistently to planning the first hour, small morning habits can improve focus, energy, discipline and the overall rhythm of a student's day. The first hour after waking up can influence how the rest of the day feels. For students, mornings often involve rushing out of bed, checking

notifications, searching for school materials and trying to reach class on time. Such a hurried start can create unnecessary stress before the day has even begun. A well-designed morning routine, however, does not need to be complicated. Simple habits such as waking at a consistent time, drinking water, moving the

body, eating a balanced breakfast and preparing for the day can create a more organised start. The science behind routines is largely about consistency: repeated behaviours gradually become easier because the brain begins to associate certain actions with particular times and situations.



Start With a Consistent Wake-Up Time

The body functions according to an internal biological clock that helps regulate sleep, alertness and daily rhythms. Waking at roughly the same time each day can support this rhythm and make mornings more predictable. Students who frequently change their wake-up time may find it harder to feel alert in the morning,

particularly after staying up late. A consistent schedule can also make it easier to plan breakfast, preparation and travel without unnecessary rushing. The goal is not to create a rigid routine that leaves no room for flexibility, but to establish a reliable starting point. Consistency can gradually make waking up feel less difficult.

Do Not Skip Breakfast Without a Plan

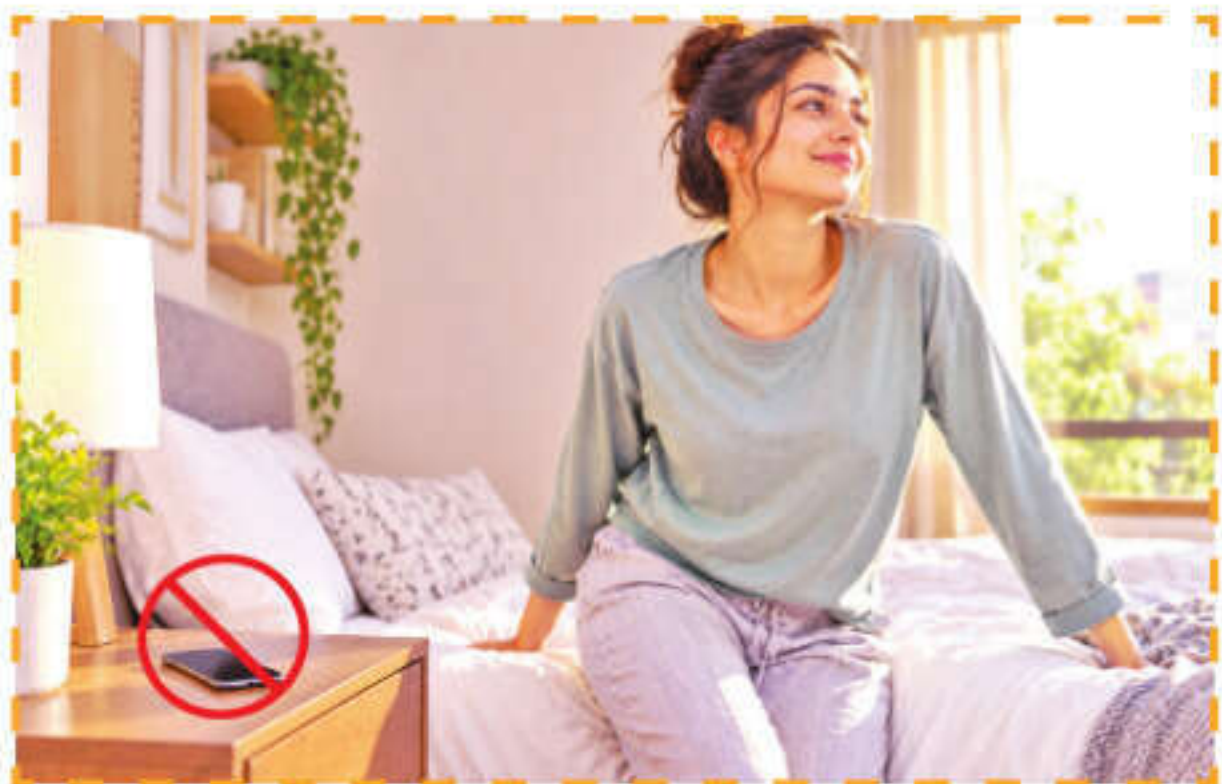
Breakfast can be an opportunity to provide the body with energy and important nutrients after the overnight fasting period. Students who rush through the morning may skip it completely or rely heavily on highly processed convenience foods. A balanced breakfast can include combinations of whole grains, fruit, dairy or alternatives, eggs, nuts or other nutritious options

according to individual preferences and dietary needs. Planning breakfast in advance can make healthy choices easier on busy mornings. However, students should also recognise that nutritional needs differ between individuals. The larger lesson is to avoid allowing hectic mornings to consistently interfere with regular, balanced eating habits.

Avoid Reaching for the Phone Immediately

For many students, the phone is the first object they reach for after waking. Notifications, short videos and social media can immediately flood the brain with information and distractions. Instead of beginning the day reactively, students can create a short phone-free period after waking. This gives them time to complete essential morning

tasks before entering the digital world. Checking messages later can also reduce the temptation to lose valuable time scrolling. The objective is not to reject technology but to control when it enters the morning routine. Starting the day intentionally can make it easier to focus on priorities instead of responding to endless notifications.



Give Your Body Some Movement

Physical movement can help students transition from sleep to an active day. It does not have to mean a demanding workout. Stretching, walking, yoga, light exercises or a few minutes of outdoor movement can be enough to introduce activity into the morning. Regular physical activity supports overall health and can help students feel more energetic. Morning

movement can also become a useful transition between sleeping and studying. Students who dislike formal exercise can choose something simple that they enjoy. The important point is consistency rather than intensity. A routine that is easy to repeat is more sustainable than an ambitious programme that quickly becomes difficult to maintain.



Prepare the Night Before

A successful morning often begins the previous evening. Packing a school bag, arranging books, preparing clothes and checking the next day's schedule can remove several decisions from the morning. This can be particularly helpful for students who frequently forget assignments or school materials. Preparing ahead also reduces the need to rush, which can make mornings calmer. The habit is simple: identify what tomorrow requires and complete as much preparation as possible today. This creates a smoother transition between sleeping and starting the day. Good routines are therefore not limited to morning behaviour; they often depend on small systems created the night before.

Create a Short Planning Ritual

Students do not need a complicated productivity system to organise their day. Spending a few minutes identifying the day's most important tasks can provide direction. A simple list of two or three priorities may be more useful than writing an unrealistic schedule containing dozens of activities. Planning can include schoolwork, extracurricular activities, household responsibilities and personal time. The purpose is to create clarity rather than pressure. When students know what needs attention, they may spend less time deciding what to do next. Over time, this habit can support organisation and reduce the feeling that the entire day is being controlled by unexpected tasks.

Add Something Enjoyable

A morning routine should not feel like a punishment. Including a small enjoyable activity can make the routine more appealing and sustainable. Students might listen to music, read a few pages of a book, spend time with family, care for plants or simply sit quietly for a few minutes. Enjoyable moments can create a positive association with mornings. The activity does not need to be long; even five or ten minutes can make the routine feel more personal. When students design routines around habits they genuinely enjoy, they are more likely to repeat them. A good routine should provide structure without removing the pleasure from the beginning of the day.

Key Takeaway: Consistency Beats Complexity

A better morning routine does not require an elaborate schedule or dozens of productivity hacks. The most effective routine is one that supports a student's real needs and can be followed

consistently. Regular waking times, reduced morning screen use, physical movement, balanced nutrition, preparation and simple planning can create a more organised start to the day.

Students should experiment with different habits and keep the ones that genuinely improve their mornings. There will always be days when routines change because of examinations, travel or

special events. What matters is returning to healthy habits afterwards. A strong morning is not about perfection—it is about creating a dependable beginning that supports the rest of the day.